Stepping into Advanced Playing

Secure reading, efficient movement and purposeful practice.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Your advanced starting point
2. Diagnose before repeating
3. Prepare a leap without reaching
4. Hear three layers at once
5. Design a useful practice session
6. Abide with Me: three listening layers
7. Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee: read ahead
8. Holy, Holy, Holy: a clear chorale

1. Your advanced starting point

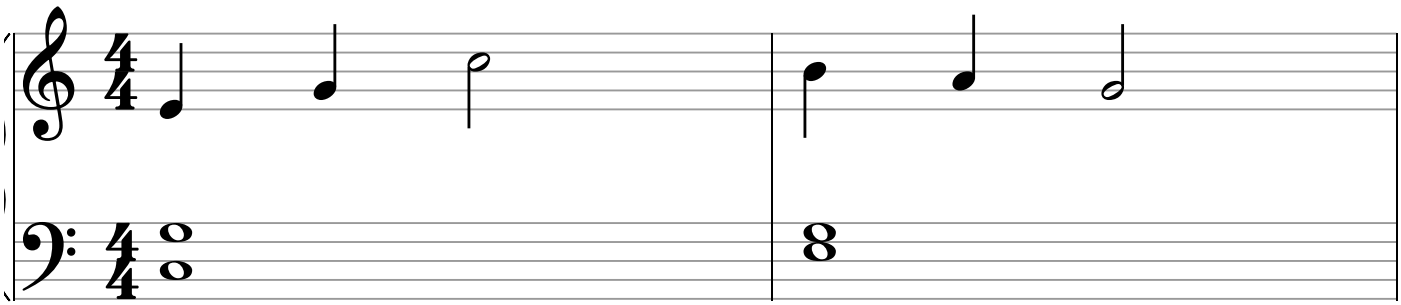
Assess reading, pulse, voicing and comfortable movement.

Your advanced starting point

Begin with a quiet, unhurried check. Read both staves, identify the key and meter, and silently prepare one bar. The melody should remain audible above the bass. Advanced study assumes comfortable intermediate reading, scales, chords and pedal changes. If either hand hesitates repeatedly, return to that intermediate skill while keeping this course available. Use an 88-key piano with a sustain pedal; start without pedal so it cannot hide gaps.

Practise · A balanced opening

Count four even beats. Make the right hand sing above a quiet left hand.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Read the bass before playing

Name the changing bass notes, then play the upper line without looking at lit keys.

Practise independently

Play once without hints, then describe the weakest element: reading, pulse, movement or balance. Choose one measurable practice goal, such as three calm entries into bar 2. Progress when the sound is controlled, not merely when the pitches register.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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2. Diagnose before repeating

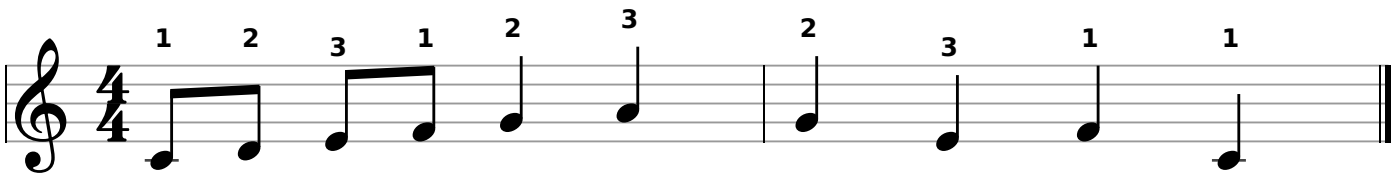
Choose a repair that addresses the cause of a mistake.

Diagnose before repeating

Repeated runs can rehearse the same hesitation. First name the cause: uncertain notes, a rhythm you cannot clap, an awkward fingering or a movement you have not prepared. Simplify only that part. For a leap, rehearse the silent landing. For a rhythm, clap and count. For a coordination problem, play the hands separately, then join one beat before and after the join.

Practise · Repair a crossing

Practise E-F with 3-1 twice, then reconnect the whole four-note group.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Repair the join

Start at the last two beats of the previous harmony. Keep the same pulse through the change.

Practise independently

Write a one-sentence diagnosis and a matching repair. After two successful slow attempts, play the complete phrase. If the error returns, shorten the repair rather than adding more full runs.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

3. Prepare a leap without reaching

Move toward a destination while releasing unnecessary tension.

Prepare a leap without reaching

A leap is a movement between places, not a large fixed hand shape. Look at the destination before leaving, release the old note and carry the forearm toward the new one. Begin with a generous rest. Remove the rest only after the landing is reliable. Keep the wrist mobile and the shoulder quiet; pain or persistent tension means stop and reassess the movement.

Practise · Right-hand destinations

Play, release, look and land. Do not keep the hand stretched across the octave.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Bass then chord

Use each rest to travel from the bass to a compact chord.

Practise independently

Rehearse the motion silently, then at a soft dynamic. Close the rest gradually while keeping the landing accurate. Never trade comfort for the metronome number.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

4. Hear three layers at once

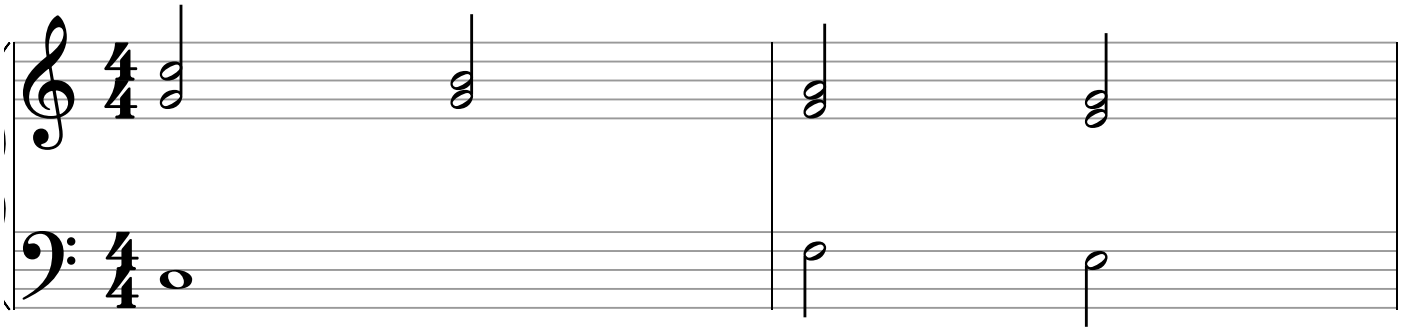
Separate melody, inner support and bass in your listening.

Hear three layers at once

Think of a hymn texture as several singers. First sing the melody while playing the bass. Then sing an inner line by itself. Finally restore the written chords, keeping the melody most present, the bass clear and the inner notes lighter. Balance is a listening task; pressing every chord tone with identical force can bury the tune.

Practise · Melody above paired notes

Play only the top notes once. Restore the lower right-hand notes softly.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Bass direction

Hear the bass as a line moving independently beneath the melody.

Practise independently

Record a short phrase. Can you hum the melody easily and still follow the bass? Repeat with the inner notes quieter, without slowing their attacks.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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5. Design a useful practice session
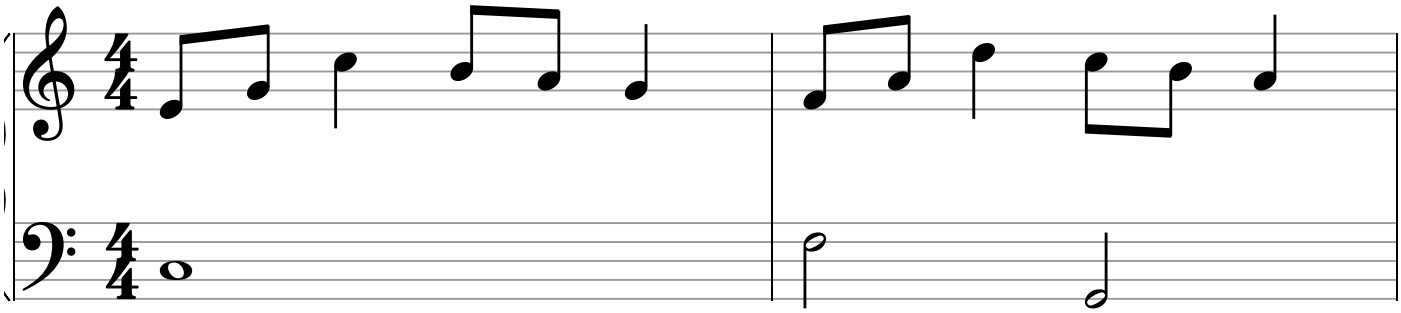
Balance technical repair, reading and an uninterrupted performance.

Design a useful practice session

Use three modes deliberately. In repair mode, stop and inspect a small passage. In reading mode, choose manageable unfamiliar music and preserve the pulse. In performance mode, continue to the next landmark after an error. A useful twenty-minute session might contain four minutes of movement, eight of focused repair, four of reading and four of a complete hymn. Adjust the proportions to your actual difficulty.

Practise · A small repair window

Loop the middle bar, then practise all three bars as a sentence.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A fresh entry

Start on this dominant harmony without playing the earlier phrase.

Practise independently

Choose a repair tempo, a specific success criterion and a stopping point before practising. Finish by playing one complete musical phrase, then note what tomorrow needs.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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6. Abide with Me: three listening layers

Keep a clear melody above light inner support and a directed bass. Start dry, then add only enough pedal to connect the phrase.

Prepare the score

Keep a clear melody above light inner support and a directed bass. Start dry, then add only enough pedal to connect the phrase.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Keep a clear melody above light inner support and a directed bass. Start dry, then add only enough pedal to connect the phrase.

Practise · Abide with Me: three listening layers

Keep a clear melody above light inner support and a directed bass. Start dry, then add only enough pedal to connect the phrase.

Make your own musical decision

Record a phrase. Identify the melody, inner support and bass separately, then make one balance change.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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7. Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee: read ahead

Preview each phrase in G major. Read the top line and bass first, then prepare the paired supporting notes without stopping the pulse.

Prepare the score

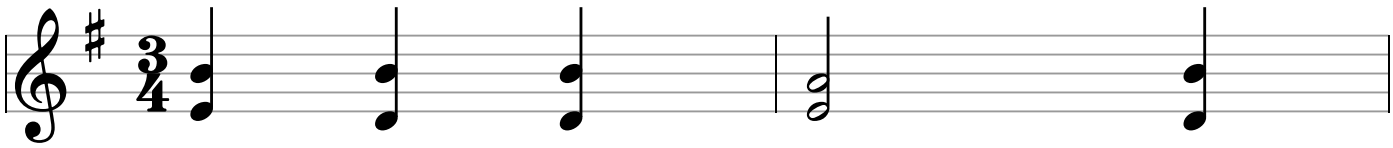
Preview each phrase in G major. Read the top line and bass first, then prepare the paired supporting notes without stopping the pulse.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 3/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Preview each phrase in G major. Read the top line and bass first, then prepare the paired supporting notes without stopping the pulse.

Practise · Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee: read ahead

Preview each phrase in G major. Read the top line and bass first, then prepare the paired supporting notes without stopping the pulse.

Make your own musical decision

Choose three phrase entries and begin directly from each without a run-up.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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8. Holy, Holy, Holy: a clear chorale

Show a continuous pulse, a clear upper voice, planned movement and a calm final release.

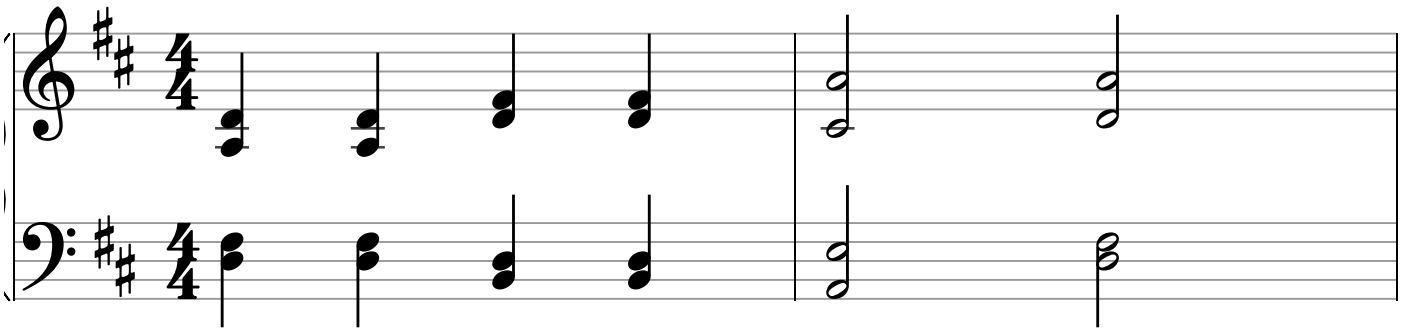
Prepare a complete performance

Show a continuous pulse, a clear upper voice, planned movement and a calm final release.

Choose a tempo at which you can finish comfortably. Mark three restart points, rehearse the opening and ending, then play without stopping. Afterwards assess pulse, clarity, phrasing, balance and recovery. Completion records a reference play-through, not a graded qualification or approval of an improvised arrangement.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Holy, Holy, Holy

Show a continuous pulse, a clear upper voice, planned movement and a calm final release.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Show a continuous pulse, a clear upper voice, planned movement and a calm final release.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Assess reading, pulse, voicing and comfortable movement.
- ☐ Choose a repair that addresses the cause of a mistake.
- ☐ Move toward a destination while releasing unnecessary tension.
- ☐ Separate melody, inner support and bass in your listening.
- ☐ Balance technical repair, reading and an uninterrupted performance.
- ☐ Show a continuous pulse, a clear upper voice, planned movement and a calm final release.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Advanced Keyboard Technique

More keys, broad arpeggios, comfortable octaves and bass-to-chord travel.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Fluent major scales in more keys
2. Harmonic and melodic minor
3. Broad arpeggios with continuous movement
4. Comfortable octaves and lighter alternatives
5. Bass-to-chord accompaniment
6. Come Thou Fount: travelling accompaniment
7. Crown Him with Many Crowns: octave colour
8. Eternal Father, Strong to Save: flowing piano

1. Fluent major scales in more keys

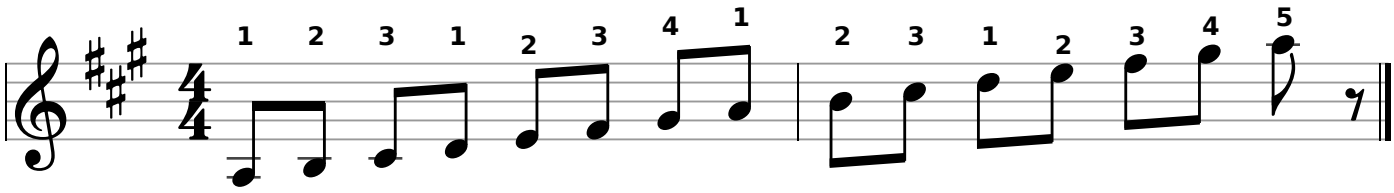
Plan black-key fingerings and even crossings in A and E.

Fluent major scales in more keys

Treat black keys as landmarks. In right-hand A and E major the usual ascending pattern begins 1-2-3, crosses to 1, then continues 2-3-4 before the next crossing. Practise one hand at a time, then match both hands offline. Keep the thumb close to the keys and move the arm along the scale. Add B-flat, E-flat and A-flat from their own fingering patterns; do not reuse C fingering blindly.

Practise · A major across two octaves

Use finger 1 at the middle A. Keep G-sharp light before the crossing.



Opening example · 4/4 · A · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · E major and return

Practise the crossing in both directions; keep the same pulse.

Practise independently

Descend the A scale offline, then practise the left hand separately with a planned fingering. Expand to four octaves only when two sound even and the crossings stay free.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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2. Harmonic and melodic minor
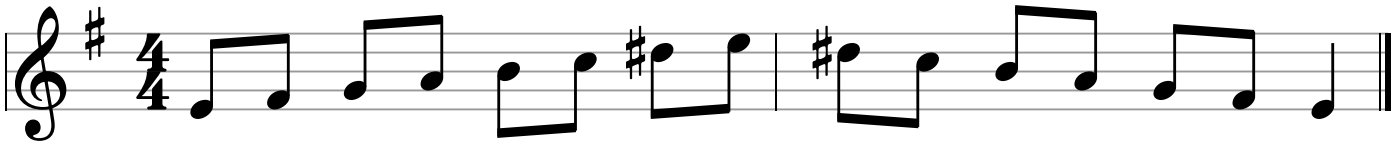
Choose a minor form by its melodic and harmonic purpose.

Harmonic and melodic minor

Harmonic minor raises scale degree 7 to strengthen the dominant. In the common classical melodic-minor exercise, degrees 6 and 7 rise on the ascent and return to natural minor on the descent. Actual music may use either form in either direction. In E minor, compare C-D, C-D-sharp and C-sharp-D-sharp before returning to E. Listen to the sound of each choice, not just its fingering.

Practise · E harmonic minor

Hear D-sharp lean toward E, then descend with the same raised seventh.



Opening example · 4/4 · Em · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · E melodic-minor exercise

Raise C and D on the ascent; return to C and D natural on the descent.

> **Review**
>
> Which notes rise in the common ascending melodic-minor exercise?
>
> **Answer:** Degrees 6 and 7 Degrees 6 and 7 rise; the exercise commonly descends in natural minor. Musical passages can vary.

Practise independently

Sing the upper four notes of each form. Then transpose the comparison to A minor offline. Explain how a raised seventh changes the pull toward the tonic.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

3. Broad arpeggios with continuous movement

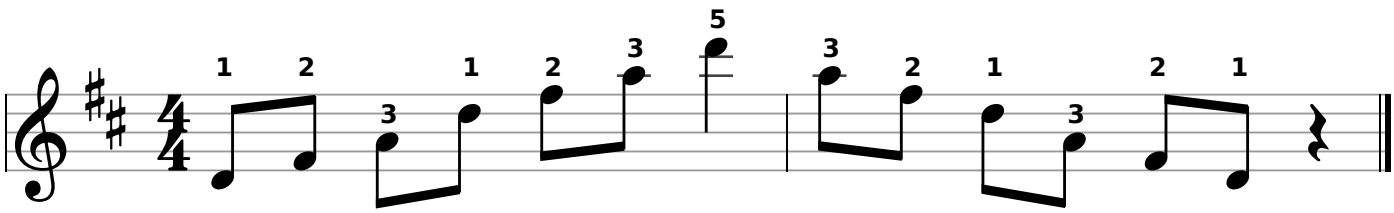
Coordinate crossings without holding an open stretch.

Broad arpeggios with continuous movement

Locate the chord tones before choosing a fingering. Let the forearm move toward the next octave while the current fingers finish. Practise the crossing pair without twisting the wrist. The left-hand C fingering below uses 5-4-2-1 across one octave, then 4 after the thumb when continuing. A small hand may need another comfortable plan. Keep the sound even at the joins.

Practise · Right-hand D-major arpeggio

Move through 1-2-3, then prepare 1 on the next D.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left-hand C-major arpeggio

Release each note as needed so the arm can travel; do not freeze the thumb.

Practise independently

Compare the volume before and after every crossing. Loop a crossing with its approach note. Extend the same movement to a hymn accompaniment only after the technical pattern feels settled.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

4. Comfortable octaves and lighter alternatives

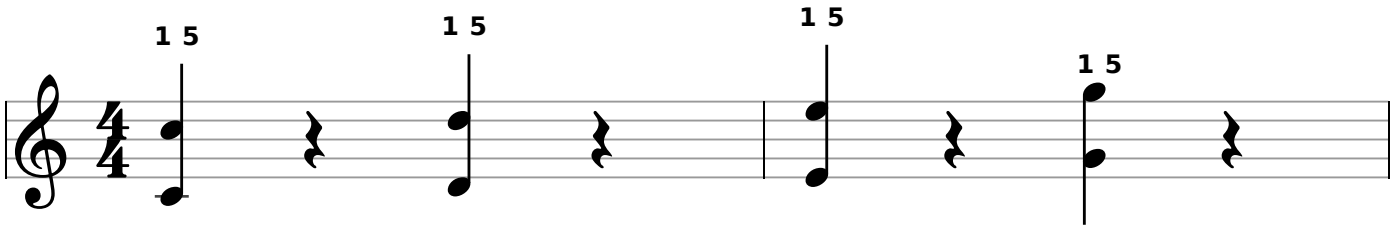
Use release and arm movement instead of gripping.

Comfortable octaves and lighter alternatives

Only practise blocked octaves if your hand spans them comfortably. Keep the hand elastic and release between attacks; do not lock the wrist or force the fingers apart. Begin slowly and softly with a few repetitions. A single melody note or a broken octave is a valid substitute. Octave sound should serve a climactic phrase, not make every line heavy.

Practise · Short octave groups

Use 1-5 only if comfortable. Otherwise select one hand and play the upper note as an offline alternative.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Broken-octave alternative

Travel between the notes and release; this is not a held stretch.

Practise independently

Compare the blocked and broken versions. Choose the one that stays comfortable and makes the melody clearer. Stop the octave exercise if tension builds.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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5. Bass-to-chord accompaniment

Land quietly after a broad left-hand movement.

Bass-to-chord accompaniment

See the bass and chord as two destinations. After the bass sounds, look at the chord before moving. Practise the chord landing silently, then add the bass. Pedal may connect the sound after the movement is secure, but it must clear with the harmony. The bass should support the phrase without becoming a repeated accent.

Practise · Waltz support

Play bass on beat 1 and light chords on beats 2 and 3.



Opening example · 3/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Support under a tune

Look ahead to the chord while keeping the right-hand phrase moving.

Practise independently

Repeat at a soft dynamic with no pedal. Add shallow pedal offline, clearing after each new bass, and check that adjacent harmonies remain distinct.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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6. Come Thou Fount: travelling accompaniment

Learn the D-major melody first. Keep the flowing eighths below it and let the arm move between the left-hand destinations.

Prepare the score
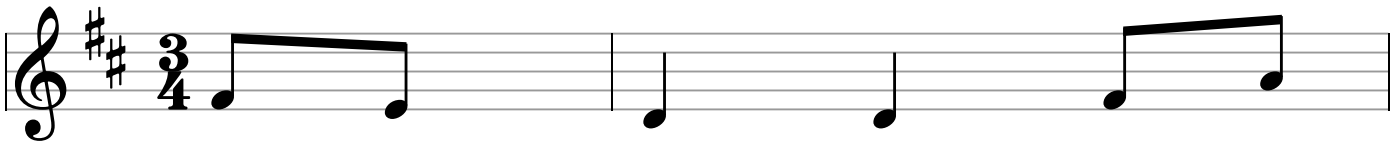
Learn the D-major melody first. Keep the flowing eighths below it and let the arm move between the left-hand destinations.

The left-hand pattern samples the retained source harmonies at each eighth note. It is an original piano accompaniment.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 3/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Learn the D-major melody first. Keep the flowing eighths below it and let the arm move between the left-hand destinations.

Practise · Come Thou Fount: travelling accompaniment

Learn the D-major melody first. Keep the flowing eighths below it and let the arm move between the left-hand destinations.

Make your own musical decision

Loop one crossing at a soft dynamic, then join the approach and following bar.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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7. Crown Him with Many Crowns: octave colour

Use the octave melody only if the span is comfortable. Rehearse it slowly with clear releases. The original source is adapted to half note values and regular 4/4 here.

Prepare the score

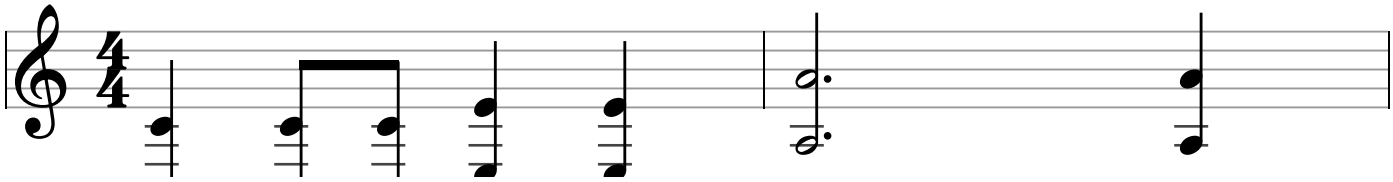
Use the octave melody only if the span is comfortable. Rehearse it slowly with clear releases. The original source is adapted to half note values and regular 4/4 here.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Use the octave melody only if the span is comfortable. Rehearse it slowly with clear releases. The original source is adapted to half note values and regular 4/4 here.

Practise · Crown Him with Many Crowns: octave colour

Use the octave melody only if the span is comfortable. Rehearse it slowly with clear releases. The original source is adapted to half note values and regular 4/4 here.

Make your own musical decision

Try a single-note melody offline as a lighter alternative. Decide where an octave actually improves the phrase; use the printed octave model for the pitch check.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

8. Eternal Father, Strong to Save: flowing piano

Keep the chromatic melody secure above light moving accompaniment. Move rather than hold a wide left-hand stretch.

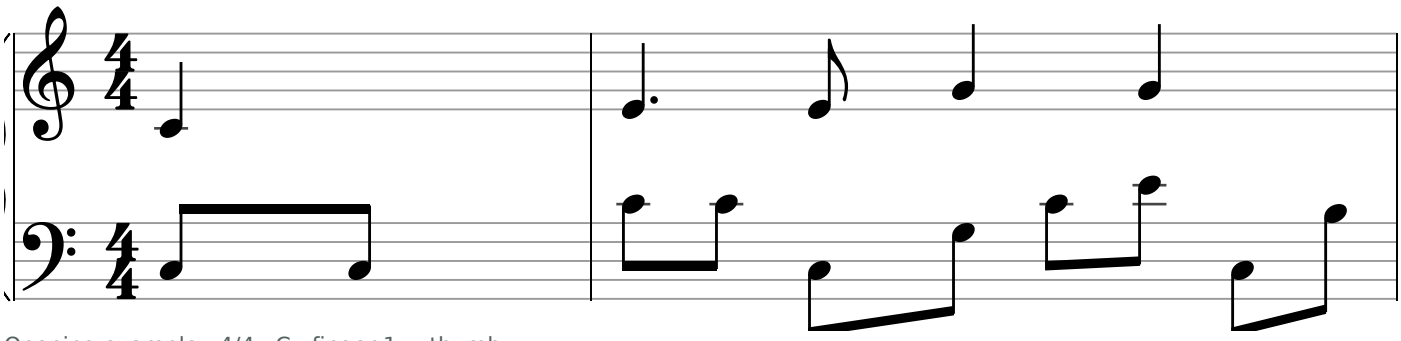
Prepare a complete performance

Keep the chromatic melody secure above light moving accompaniment. Move rather than hold a wide left-hand stretch.

Choose a tempo at which you can finish comfortably. Mark three restart points, rehearse the opening and ending, then play without stopping. Afterwards assess pulse, clarity, phrasing, balance and recovery. Completion records a reference play-through, not a graded qualification or approval of an improvised arrangement.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Eternal Father, Strong to Save

Keep the chromatic melody secure above light moving accompaniment. Move rather than hold a wide left-hand stretch.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Keep the chromatic melody secure above light moving accompaniment. Move rather than hold a wide left-hand stretch.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- [ ] Plan black-key fingerings and even crossings in A and E.
- [ ] Choose a minor form by its melodic and harmonic purpose.
- [ ] Coordinate crossings without holding an open stretch.
- [ ] Use release and arm movement instead of gripping.
- [ ] Land quietly after a broad left-hand movement.
- [ ] Keep the chromatic melody secure above light moving accompaniment. Move rather than hold a wide left-hand stretch.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Reading Hymns in Four Parts

Understand each voice, sustain deliberately and make practical reductions.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Map soprano, alto, tenor and bass
2. Bring an inner voice into focus
3. Read the tenor across the middle
4. Sustain one voice while another moves
5. Reduce a hymn without losing its identity
6. Holy, Holy, Holy: hear the inner lines
7. Abide with Me: outer voices and support
8. Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee: chorale reading

1. Map soprano, alto, tenor and bass

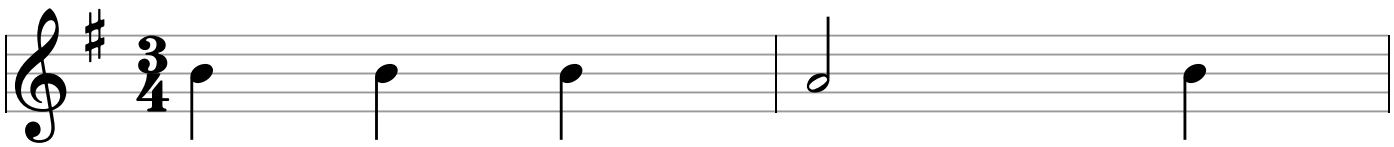
Follow a voice through the texture before reading every chord.

Map soprano, alto, tenor and bass

A four-part hymn is four musical lines. Soprano is usually the tune, alto sits beneath it, tenor lies above the bass, and bass supports the harmony. Begin by naming the first note of each line. Read the outer voices, then sing an inner voice while playing one outer line. Two-staff chord reductions in this course align supporting attacks with the melody; use the linked source for the original independent rhythms.

Practise · Soprano line: Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee: Soprano

Sing this voice, then play it alone. Notice its direction and its place in the harmony.



Opening example · 3/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Bass line: Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee: Bass

Sing this voice, then play it alone. Notice its direction and its place in the harmony.

Practise independently

Open the source score and trace one entire phrase in each voice. Say which voice moves by step and which repeats notes. Do not infer a voice only from which hand plays it.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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2. Bring an inner voice into focus

Hear the alto independently of the soprano.

Bring an inner voice into focus

An inner voice is easy to overlook because the ear follows the tune. Sing the alto slowly, then play it without the soprano. Notice repeated notes and small steps. When restoring the melody, let the alto remain connected and quieter. A finger substitution can connect repeated hand positions offline, but it should not distort the pulse.

Practise · Alto line: Abide with Me: Alto

Sing this voice, then play it alone. Notice its direction and its place in the harmony.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Two right-hand voices

Play the lower line alone first: E-F-E-D-E. Then restore the upper voice.

Practise independently

Sing the alto while playing only the bass offline. Then record both hands and check whether the inner line still sounds like a musical sentence.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

3. Read the tenor across the middle
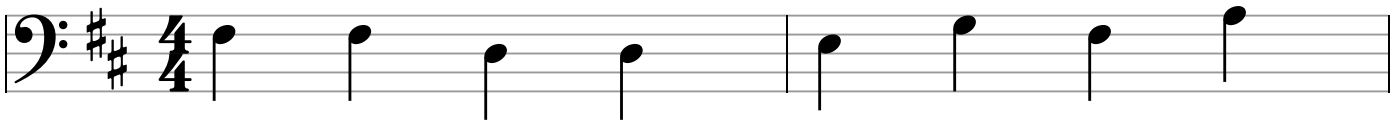
Track the line even when the hands redistribute notes.

Read the tenor across the middle

On a piano, the tenor may be played by the left hand or shared with the right to avoid an awkward stretch. The voice keeps its identity when the hand changes. Read the tenor as a melody, check its clef and octave, and compare it with the bass. Redistribution should preserve the important line and make movement easier; mark the hand change before practising.

Practise · Tenor line: Holy, Holy, Holy: Tenor

Sing this voice, then play it alone. Notice its direction and its place in the harmony.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Tenor and bass in one hand

Hear the upper left-hand notes as a line; keep the bass underneath them.

Practise independently

In the source opening, find any span that feels awkward. Try moving a tenor note to the right hand offline, then compare the sound and comfort. The app reference retains its printed hand assignment.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

4. Sustain one voice while another moves

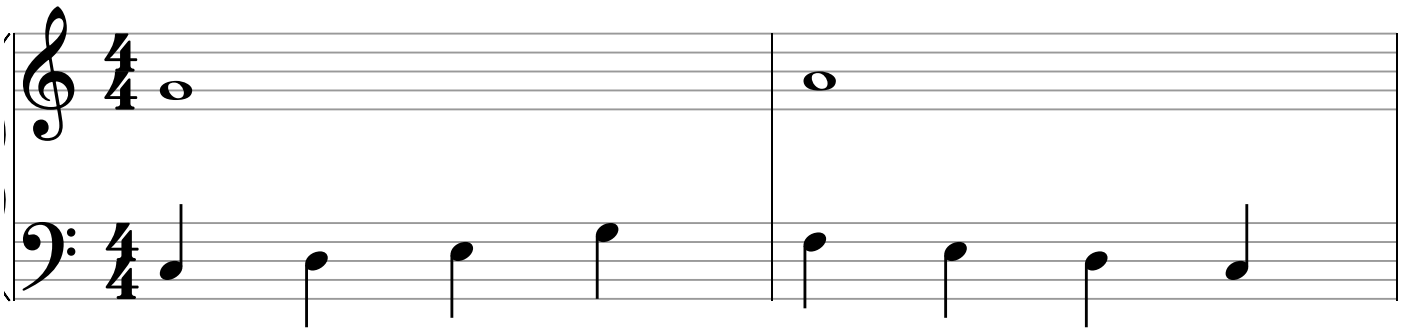
Release only the notes whose written values have ended.

Sustain one voice while another moves

Do not lift the entire hand just because one line changes. Practise one sustained note while another hand moves, then try the same idea within one hand away from the pitch checker. For the within-hand task, hold right-hand C5 with finger 5 while fingers 1-2-3 play E4-F4-G4-F4. Use separate silent preparation first and choose a smaller span if necessary. Pedal should not replace the finger coordination being practised.

Practise · Held soprano, moving bass

Keep the right-hand G sounding while the left line changes underneath it.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Held bass, moving melody

Change the left hand only at its written boundary.

Practise independently

Play the within-hand task offline without pedal and listen for uninterrupted C5. The app checks note attacks, so use your ears to judge whether that note actually remained held.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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5. Reduce a hymn without losing its identity
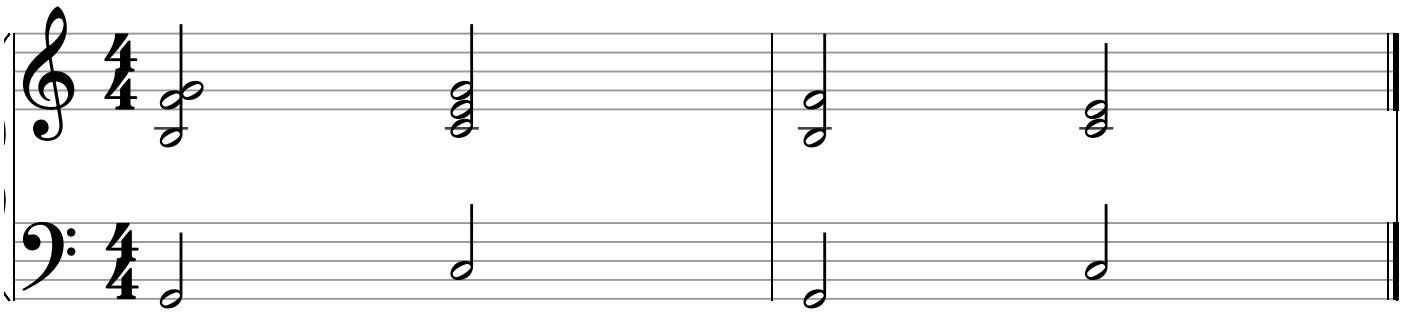
Preserve tune, bass and the notes that define the harmony.

Reduce a hymn without losing its identity

When a full chord is uncomfortable, identify what matters. Keep the melody and bass, then retain a third or seventh that explains the harmony. Remove a doubled note before removing the only defining third. Preserve a moving inner line when it carries an important resolution. Reduction is a deliberate musical choice; practise the printed reference first and compare your alternative offline.

Practise · Full chord then compact answer

Hear B-F resolve to C-E. The fifth can be omitted without losing the dominant-seventh pull.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Outer voices remain

Sing the missing middle before restoring it in your own arrangement.

Practise independently

Choose two bars from the hymn study. Make one comfortable reduction offline and explain each omitted note. Check that the melody, bass direction and cadence remain recognizable.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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6. Holy, Holy, Holy: hear the inner lines

Sing the alto and tenor from the linked source before playing this melody-led reduction. Keep each line audible in your imagination while balancing the paired notes.

Prepare the score

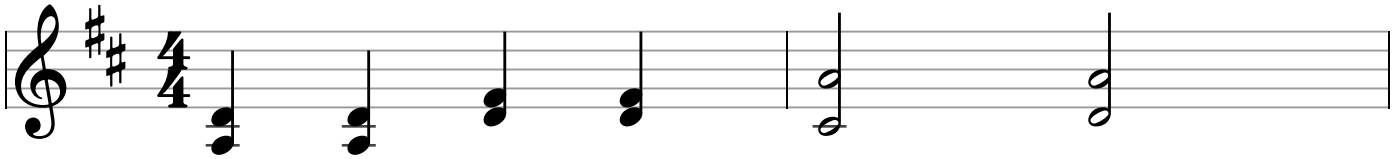
Sing the alto and tenor from the linked source before playing this melody-led reduction. Keep each line audible in your imagination while balancing the paired notes.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 4/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Sing the alto and tenor from the linked source before playing this melody-led reduction. Keep each line audible in your imagination while balancing the paired notes.

Practise · Holy, Holy, Holy: hear the inner lines

Sing the alto and tenor from the linked source before playing this melody-led reduction. Keep each line audible in your imagination while balancing the paired notes.

Make your own musical decision

Compare a source phrase with the reduction. Identify one inner rhythm that was aligned with the melody, then play the original voice alone offline.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

---

7. Abide with Me: outer voices and support

Trace the bass direction and the soprano destination. Restore the supporting tones lightly and choose comfortable hand movements.

Prepare the score

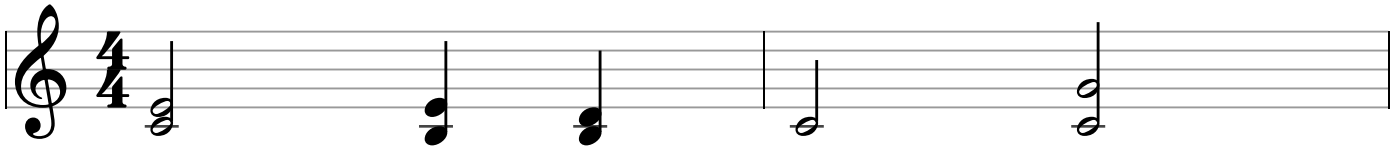
Trace the bass direction and the soprano destination. Restore the supporting tones lightly and choose comfortable hand movements.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Trace the bass direction and the soprano destination. Restore the supporting tones lightly and choose comfortable hand movements.

Practise · Abide with Me: outer voices and support

Trace the bass direction and the soprano destination. Restore the supporting tones lightly and choose comfortable hand movements.

Make your own musical decision

Make a two-voice version offline, then restore one defining inner tone. Explain what you kept and why.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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8. Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee: chorale reading

Present the complete hymn with a singing melody, a directed bass and quiet supporting notes. Understand the source voices as well as the piano reduction.

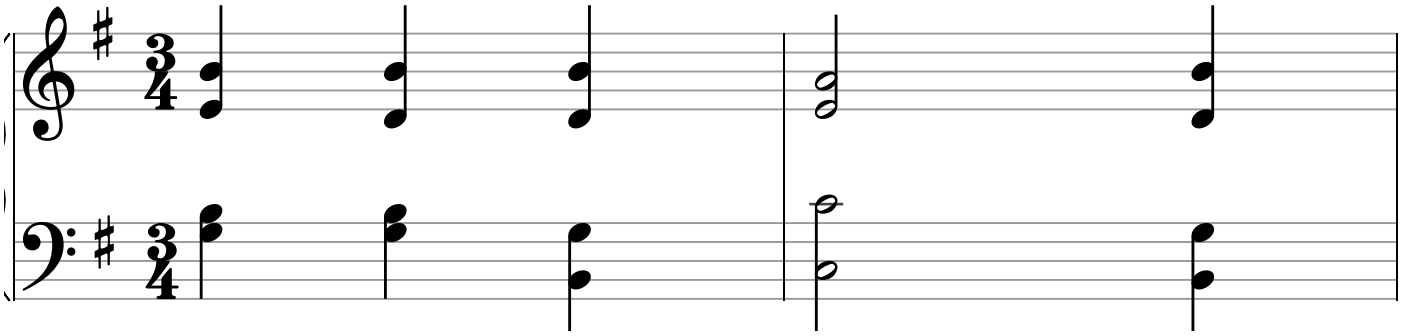
Prepare a complete performance

Present the complete hymn with a singing melody, a directed bass and quiet supporting notes. Understand the source voices as well as the piano reduction.

Choose a tempo at which you can finish comfortably. Mark three restart points, rehearse the opening and ending, then play without stopping. Afterwards assess pulse, clarity, phrasing, balance and recovery. Completion records a reference play-through, not a graded qualification or approval of an improvised arrangement.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee

Present the complete hymn with a singing melody, a directed bass and quiet supporting notes. Understand the source voices as well as the piano reduction.



Opening example · 3/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Present the complete hymn with a singing melody, a directed bass and quiet supporting notes. Understand the source voices as well as the piano reduction.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Follow a voice through the texture before reading every chord.
- ☐ Hear the alto independently of the soprano.
- ☐ Track the line even when the hands redistribute notes.
- ☐ Release only the notes whose written values have ended.
- ☐ Preserve tune, bass and the notes that define the harmony.
- ☐ Present the complete hymn with a singing melody, a directed bass and quiet supporting notes. Understand the source voices as well as the piano reduction.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Richer Hymn Harmony

Hear secondary dominants, guide chromatic notes and plan changes of key.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Use a dominant that points beyond home
2. Guide sevenths and leading notes
3. A purposeful chromatic bass
4. Make a clear change of key
5. Reharmonize with restraint
6. Eternal Father: chromatic destinations
7. Just As I Am: harmony and arrival
8. Eternal Father in F: harmonic fluency

1. Use a dominant that points beyond home

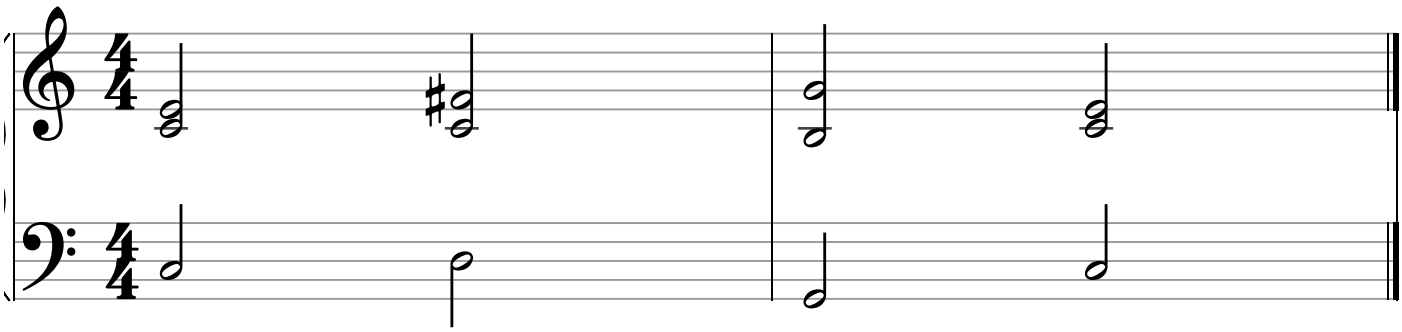
Hear V of V lead to the dominant.

Use a dominant that points beyond home

In C major, D7 contains F-sharp and points toward G. This is V of V: a temporary dominant directed at the dominant chord. F-sharp usually rises to G and the seventh C often falls to B. An accidental should have a purpose. Compare C-D7-G-C with C-Dm-G-C and listen to the different strength of the pull toward G.

Practise · V of V in C

Hear F-sharp rise to G and C fall to B.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · V of V in G

A7 leads to D: C-sharp resolves upward and G downward.

> **Review**
>
> In C major, where does D7 most directly point?
>
> **Answer:** G D7 is the dominant of G, which is the dominant in C.

Practise independently

Find a chromatic note in Melita and look at the following harmony. Name the destination before calling every accidental a modulation.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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2. Guide sevenths and leading notes
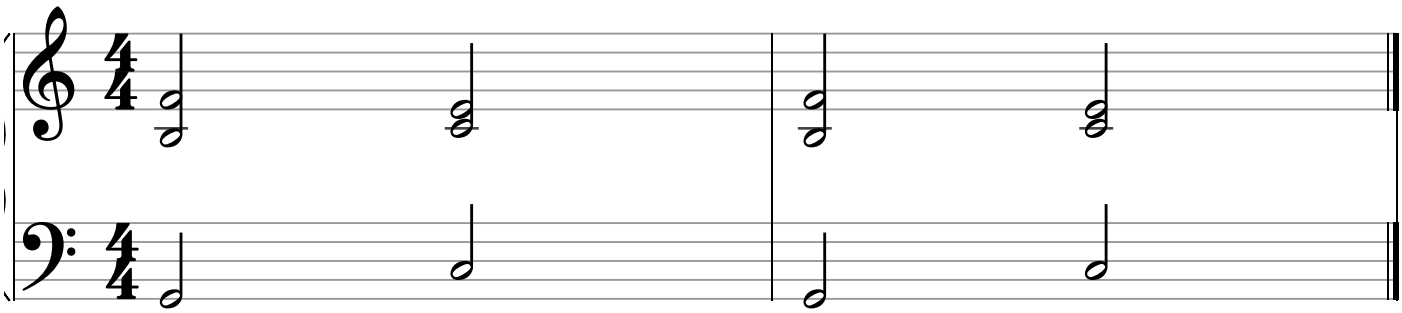
Let tendency tones resolve within clear voice leading.

Guide sevenths and leading notes

A seventh chord is more than a shape. Follow the seventh downward by step where the phrase calls for a conventional resolution, and follow the leading note toward its destination. Keep common tones where useful and avoid making every voice jump in parallel. These are listening guides for this style, not a rule that every hymn must resolve identically.

Practise · G7 resolves to C

Track the right-hand F-E and B-C motions.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A chain of destinations

D7-G7-C: hear one resolution prepare the next.

Practise independently

Play each inner line separately and sing its resolution. In the complete phrase, make the dissonance audible without accenting it harshly.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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3. A purposeful chromatic bass
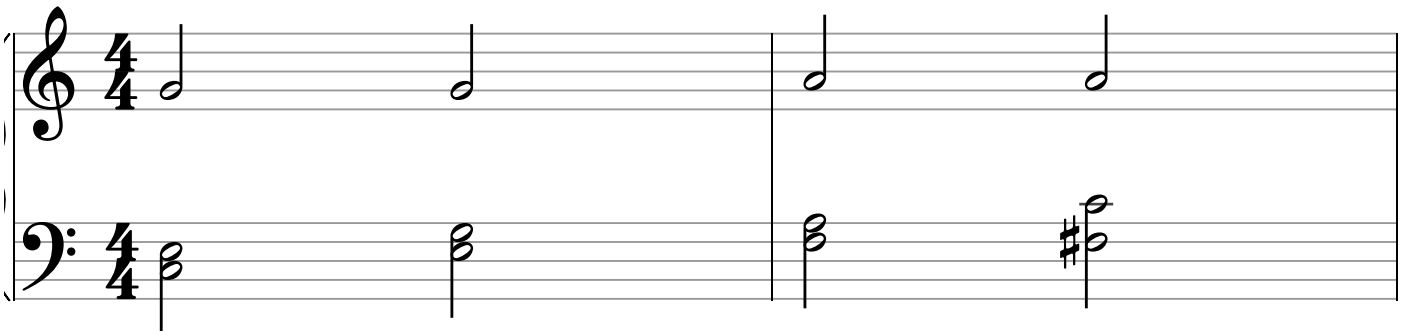
Connect harmonies without changing the melody arbitrarily.

A purposeful chromatic bass

A passing bass can connect two stable harmonies. In the model C-C/E-F-F-sharp diminished-G, the bass rises C-E-F-F-sharp-G and the diminished chord leads by small motions. Check that the melody fits each sonority; a chord that sounds attractive alone may clash with a held tune note. First understand the plain harmony, then change only one place.

Practise · Passing diminished colour

Hear F-sharp-A-C lead into G-B-D.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A descending line

Keep the top line steady over C-B-A-G.

Practise independently

Try one passing harmony in a familiar hymn offline. Sing the melody over it, then remove it. Keep the version that supports the phrase rather than the version with the most chords.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

4. Make a clear change of key

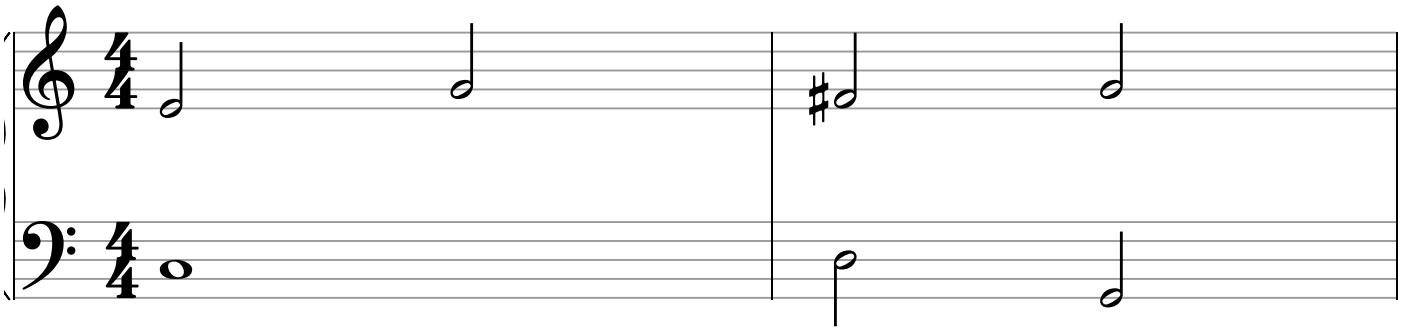
Prepare, confirm and settle into a new tonal home.

Make a clear change of key

A modulation establishes a new key; a single secondary dominant may only colour a moment. To move from C to G, a D7-G cadence can confirm the destination. Hear F-sharp as the new leading note, prepare a clear arrival, and continue a phrase in G so the listener recognizes a new home. For a singer, choose the destination for a comfortable vocal range and announce the plan before rehearsal.

Practise · C to G through D7

Hear the first C as home, then D7-G establish a new centre.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Stay in the new key

Confirm G with its own dominant, D7, before resting.

Practise independently

Play the first and last chords alone, then the complete model. Can you hear a change of home? Plan an offline whole-step transition only after the new key and singer entry are secure.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

5. Reharmonize with restraint
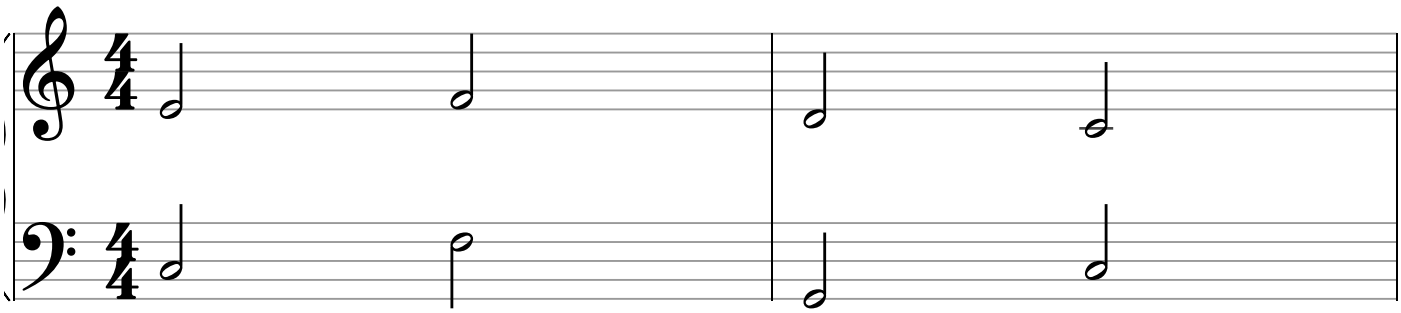
Choose substitutions that preserve melody, function and phrase.

Reharmonize with restraint

Start with the tune and bass. Mark the cadence and protect its destination. A vi chord can sometimes substitute for I, and a ii chord can prepare V, but the tune note must fit the new harmony or act as a deliberate passing tone. Try one substitution at a time. Keep a plain version ready for congregational singing; harmonic surprise should not make the entry or pulse uncertain.

Practise · One tune, two harmonic routes

Compare the same tune over a plain and a substitute progression.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Preserve the cadence

Keep B-F resolving to C-E while changing the preparation.

Practise independently

Choose four bars, label the plain chords and create one alternative offline. Sing the tune while playing only those chords. Explain why the replacement supports the line; then perform the printed reference when using the app check.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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6. Eternal Father: chromatic destinations

Read every accidental deliberately. Follow the bass and hear where each chromatic harmony leads before giving it extra weight.

Prepare the score
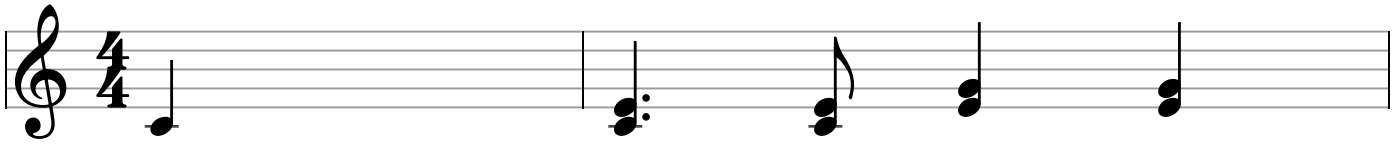
Read every accidental deliberately. Follow the bass and hear where each chromatic harmony leads before giving it extra weight.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Read every accidental deliberately. Follow the bass and hear where each chromatic harmony leads before giving it extra weight.

Practise · Eternal Father: chromatic destinations

Read every accidental deliberately. Follow the bass and hear where each chromatic harmony leads before giving it extra weight.

Make your own musical decision

Find a secondary-dominant motion in the linked source. Play its guiding tones alone and sing the resolution.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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7. Just As I Am: harmony and arrival

Read the retained 6/4 meter calmly. Protect the cadence and hear the change of harmony underneath each longer melody note.

Prepare the score
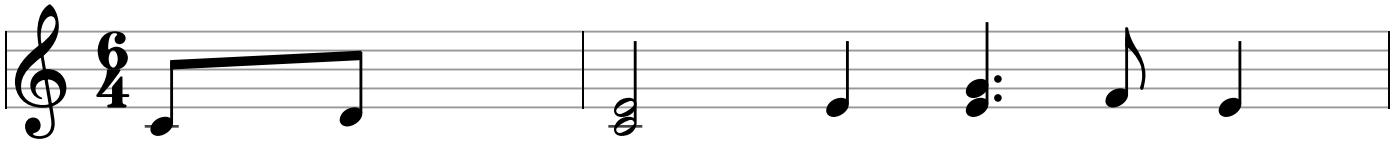
Read the retained 6/4 meter calmly. Protect the cadence and hear the change of harmony underneath each longer melody note.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 6/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Read the retained 6/4 meter calmly. Protect the cadence and hear the change of harmony underneath each longer melody note.

Practise · Just As I Am: harmony and arrival

Read the retained 6/4 meter calmly. Protect the cadence and hear the change of harmony underneath each longer melody note.

Make your own musical decision

Try one substitute preparation chord offline. Sing the tune over it and decide whether it supports the arrival.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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8. Eternal Father in F: harmonic fluency

Carry the complete tune and chromatic harmony into F major. Prepare the new key, preserve the melodic contour and resolve the guiding tones clearly.

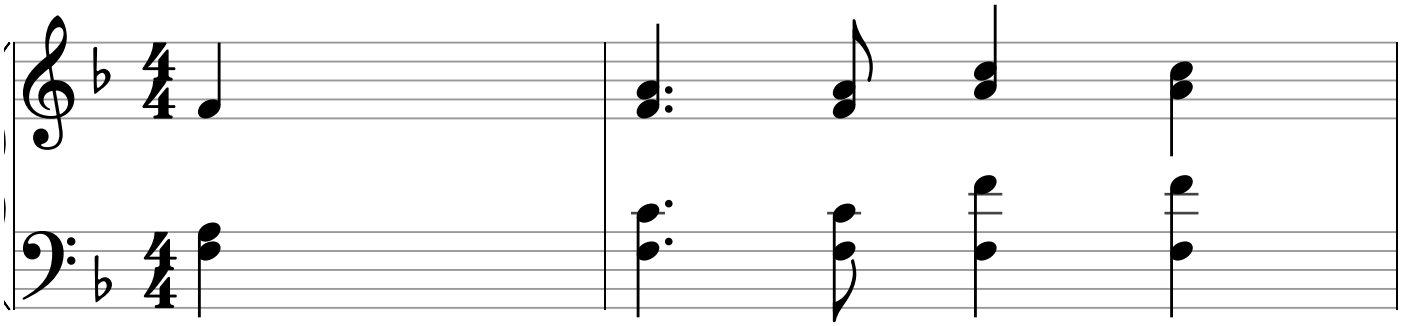
Prepare a complete performance

Carry the complete tune and chromatic harmony into F major. Prepare the new key, preserve the melodic contour and resolve the guiding tones clearly.

Choose a tempo at which you can finish comfortably. Mark three restart points, rehearse the opening and ending, then play without stopping. Afterwards assess pulse, clarity, phrasing, balance and recovery. Completion records a reference play-through, not a graded qualification or approval of an improvised arrangement.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Eternal Father, Strong to Save

Carry the complete tune and chromatic harmony into F major. Prepare the new key, preserve the melodic contour and resolve the guiding tones clearly.



Opening example · 4/4 · F · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Carry the complete tune and chromatic harmony into F major. Prepare the new key, preserve the melodic contour and resolve the guiding tones clearly.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Hear V of V lead to the dominant.
- ☐ Let tendency tones resolve within clear voice leading.
- ☐ Connect harmonies without changing the melody arbitrarily.
- ☐ Prepare, confirm and settle into a new tonal home.
- ☐ Choose substitutions that preserve melody, function and phrase.
- ☐ Carry the complete tune and chromatic harmony into F major. Prepare the new key, preserve the melodic contour and resolve the guiding tones clearly.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Advanced Rhythm and Coordination

Changing subdivisions, two against three, syncopation and compound pulse.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Keep a stable internal subdivision
2. Coordinate two against three
3. Maintain pulse through syncopation
4. Larger beats in compound time
5. Expressive timing with a shared pulse
6. Blessed Assurance: three large beats
7. Come Thou Fount: motion without rushing
8. Blessed Assurance: confident compound time

1. Keep a stable internal subdivision

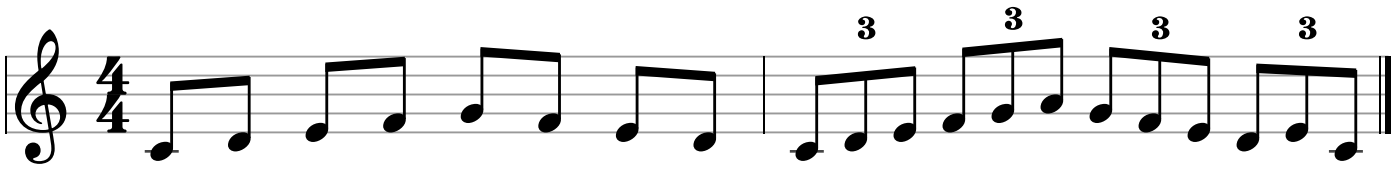
Move between quarters, eighths and triplets without changing pulse.

Keep a stable internal subdivision

Tap a steady quarter-note beat before playing. Fit two equal eighths into one tap, then three equal triplet eighths into the next. The beat does not speed up when there are more notes. Speak one-and for two and one-trip-let for three. Practise one change at a time, with no pedal, so the attacks remain clear.

Practise · Two then three

The first bar uses eighths; the second uses triplets over the same quarter pulse.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Triplets over a bass pulse

Let the left hand mark quarters while three right-hand notes fit into each beat.

Practise independently

Tap four quarters while saying the changing subdivisions. If your beat accelerates, lower the tempo and use one pitch until the switch feels steady.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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2. Coordinate two against three

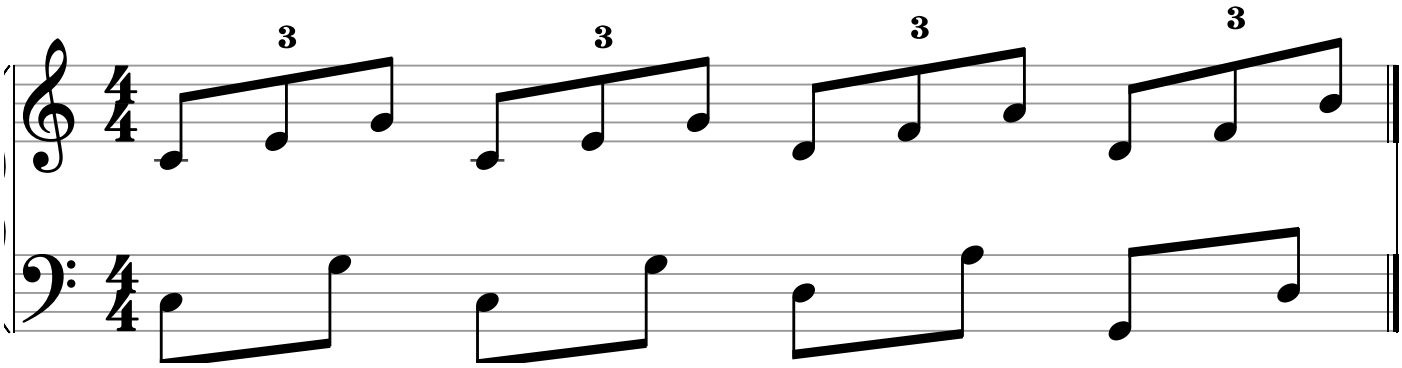
Place unequal divisions accurately within one shared beat.

Coordinate two against three

The hands meet at the start of each beat. Divide the beat into six small slots: the three-note hand plays slots 1, 3 and 5; the two-note hand plays slots 1 and 4. Clap this slowly before adding pitches. Do not swing the triplet or let the second left-hand note drag toward the last triplet. First practise a single beat, then repeat four beats.

Practise · Three right, two left

Use six silent subdivisions per beat. Both hands restart together on the next beat.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Reverse the roles

Now keep two right-hand eighths against three left-hand triplets.

Practise independently

Clap each role, then both together on your knees. Use Flow only after you can feel the shared beat. Return to separate hands if one pattern keeps changing to match the other.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

3. Maintain pulse through syncopation
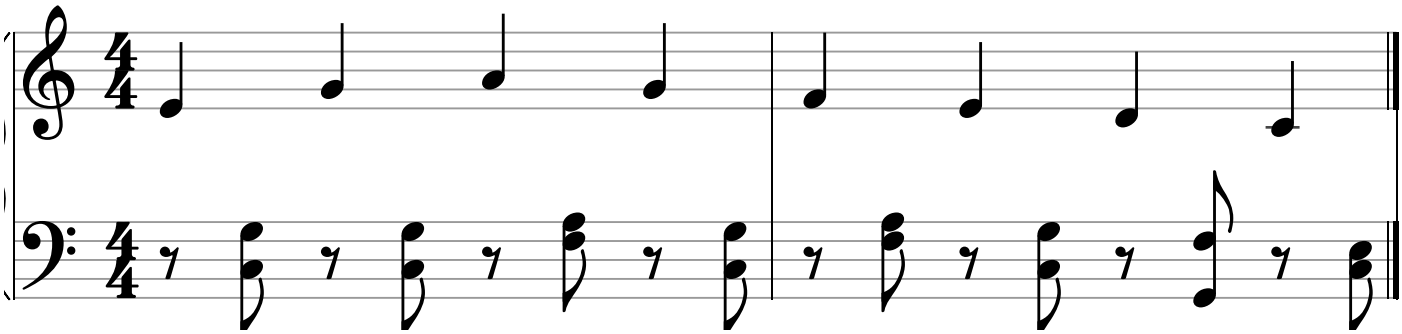
Hear the beat even when an accompaniment enters off it.

Maintain pulse through syncopation

A syncopated note may begin between beats and continue across a strong beat. Tap the pulse while speaking the rhythm. Learn the written rests as actively as the notes; an early entrance removes the syncopation. In hymn accompaniment use this texture selectively and keep the singer’s rhythm easy to follow.

Practise · Offbeat entries

Keep the melody on the beat while the left hand enters on each and.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Across the bar line

Hold the tied G through the next downbeat; do not strike it again.

Practise independently

Tap the beat with the accompaniment alone. Then restore the tune and check that the offbeat pattern supports rather than competes with the phrase.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

4. Larger beats in compound time
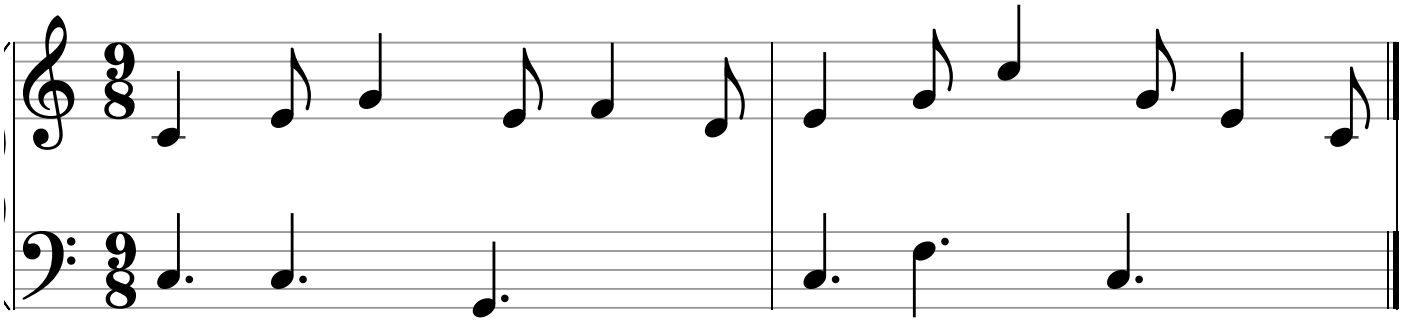
Keep three subdivisions inside each dotted-quarter pulse.

Larger beats in compound time

In 9/8 there are normally three large beats, each containing three eighths. In 6/8 there are normally two. Count the large beats and feel the smaller divisions inside them. The app tempo uses quarter-note units, so listen to the count-in rather than assuming its number is dotted-quarter beats per minute. Avoid accents on every eighth.

Practise · Three large beats

Count 1-and-a, 2-and-a, 3-and-a. Lean gently toward each phrase goal.



Opening example · 9/8 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Two large beats

Keep the bass changes at the two large pulses in each bar.

Practise independently

Conduct the large beats while listening to Blessed Assurance. Then play the melody alone, keeping pickups light and arriving on the first full large beat together.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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5. Expressive timing with a shared pulse
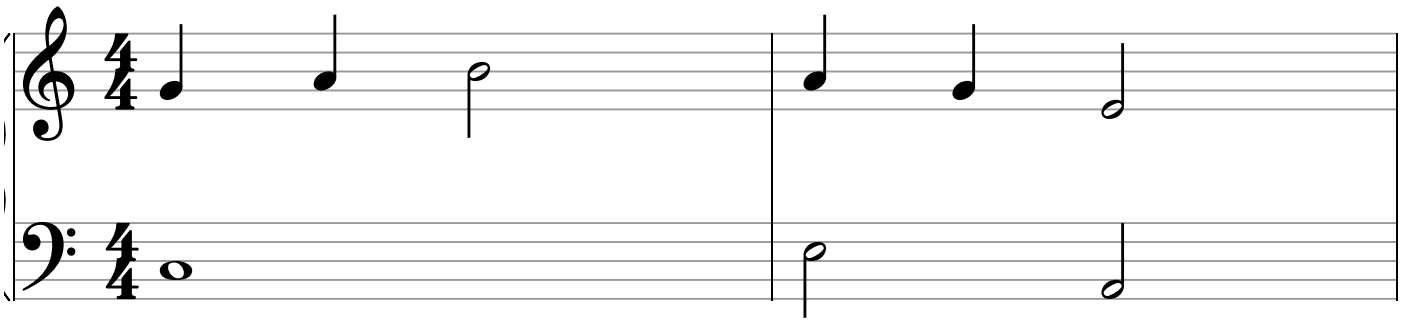
Distinguish solo rubato from timing that a singer can follow.

Expressive timing with a shared pulse

Solo rubato should clarify a phrase. Plan where the phrase moves forward and where it settles; avoid an unplanned delay at every difficult note. When accompanying a singer, agree on breaths and endings in advance and watch or listen for their lead. Practise the passage strictly first. Make the expressive version offline, because the reference timing check follows the written clock.

Practise · A stable reference

Play strictly first. Keep the same pulse through the cadence.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A singer’s breath

Count the rest fully. Prepare the next entry without a surprise early attack.

Practise independently

Perform the first phrase twice offline: once strictly and once with a planned broadening at the end. Ask whether the timing makes the sentence clearer and whether a singer could follow the entry.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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6. Blessed Assurance: three large beats

Feel three dotted-quarter pulses in 9/8, each containing three eighths. Keep the pickup light and the accompaniment even.

Prepare the score
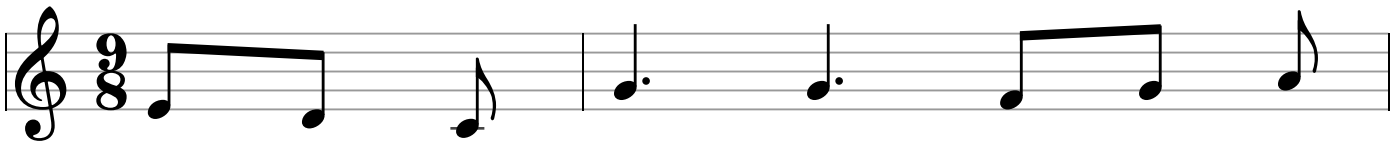
Feel three dotted-quarter pulses in 9/8, each containing three eighths. Keep the pickup light and the accompaniment even.

The left-hand pattern samples the retained source harmonies at each eighth note. It is an original piano accompaniment.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 9/8 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Feel three dotted-quarter pulses in 9/8, each containing three eighths. Keep the pickup light and the accompaniment even.

Practise · Blessed Assurance: three large beats

Feel three dotted-quarter pulses in 9/8, each containing three eighths. Keep the pickup light and the accompaniment even.

Make your own musical decision

Conduct the large beats while listening. Then play one phrase without the demonstration and check that dotted notes did not compress.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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7. Come Thou Fount: motion without rushing

Keep the three-quarter bar steady as the left hand moves in eighths. Listen for an even subdivision across every position change.

Prepare the score
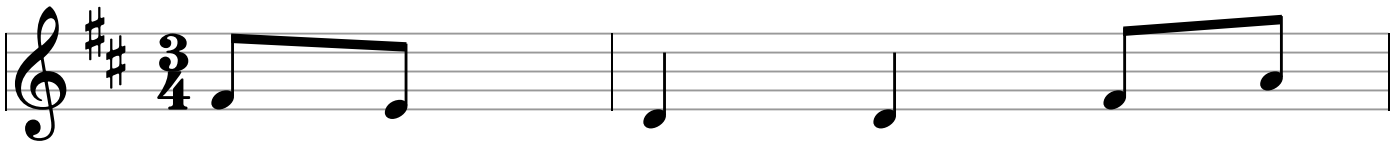
Keep the three-quarter bar steady as the left hand moves in eighths. Listen for an even subdivision across every position change.

The left-hand pattern samples the retained source harmonies at each eighth note. It is an original piano accompaniment.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 3/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Keep the three-quarter bar steady as the left hand moves in eighths. Listen for an even subdivision across every position change.

Practise · Come Thou Fount: motion without rushing

Keep the three-quarter bar steady as the left hand moves in eighths. Listen for an even subdivision across every position change.

Make your own musical decision

Practise one phrase strictly, then try a restrained planned broadening offline. Return to the strict reference for a Flow timing check.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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8. Blessed Assurance: confident compound time

Keep the large 9/8 pulse through the verse and refrain, with a clear melody above a soft, even moving accompaniment.

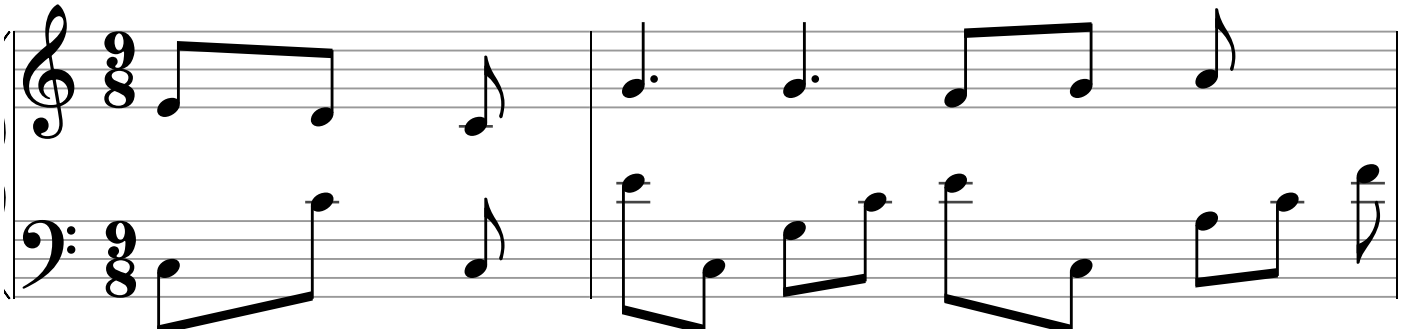
Prepare a complete performance

Keep the large 9/8 pulse through the verse and refrain, with a clear melody above a soft, even moving accompaniment.

Choose a tempo at which you can finish comfortably. Mark three restart points, rehearse the opening and ending, then play without stopping. Afterwards assess pulse, clarity, phrasing, balance and recovery. Completion records a reference play-through, not a graded qualification or approval of an improvised arrangement.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Blessed Assurance

Keep the large 9/8 pulse through the verse and refrain, with a clear melody above a soft, even moving accompaniment.



Opening example · 9/8 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Keep the large 9/8 pulse through the verse and refrain, with a clear melody above a soft, even moving accompaniment.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Move between quarters, eighths and triplets without changing pulse.
- ☐ Place unequal divisions accurately within one shared beat.
- ☐ Hear the beat even when an accompaniment enters off it.
- ☐ Keep three subdivisions inside each dotted-quarter pulse.
- ☐ Distinguish solo rubato from timing that a singer can follow.
- ☐ Keep the large 9/8 pulse through the verse and refrain, with a clear melody above a soft, even moving accompaniment.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Interpretation and Tone

Voicing, long phrases, pedal clarity, articulation and critical listening.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Project a melody inside a chord
2. Shape a long musical sentence
3. Pedal for clarity and colour
4. Choose articulation that fits the hymn
5. Use a recording as a teacher
6. Abide with Me: a long musical sentence
7. Just As I Am: listening through pedal changes
8. It Is Well with My Soul: lyrical piano

1. Project a melody inside a chord

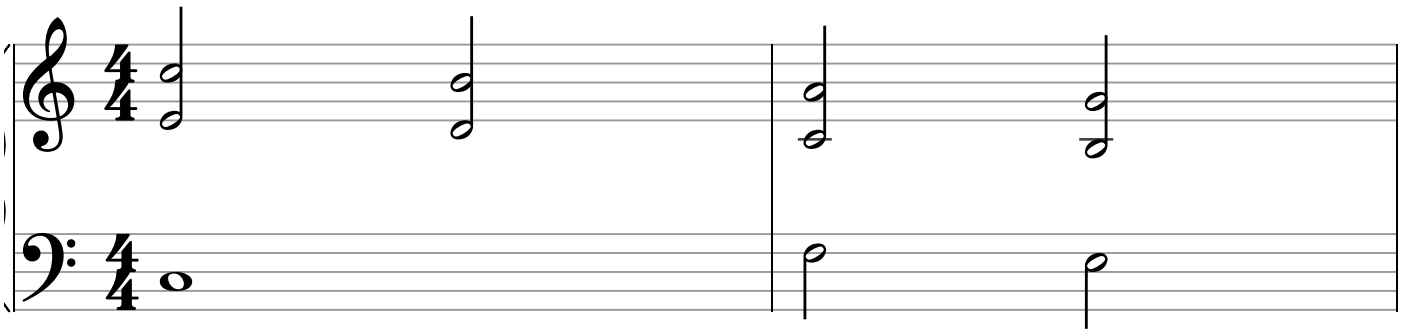
Give the upper voice direction without striking it harshly.

Project a melody inside a chord

Practise the top line alone and sing toward one destination. Restore the lower chord tones at a softer dynamic, then compare recordings. A clear melody does not require a hard attack; reduce the accompaniment first. Prepare each chord shape before moving, and keep the hand responsive rather than pressing into the keys after the sound has begun.

Practise · A singing top line

First play C-B-A-G-F-G-C alone. Then restore the lower tones softly.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Quiet middle, clear bass

Hear the outer lines while the inner chord remains light.

Practise independently

Record from the same position and volume twice. Choose the version in which a listener can follow the melody without having to search for it.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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2. Shape a long musical sentence

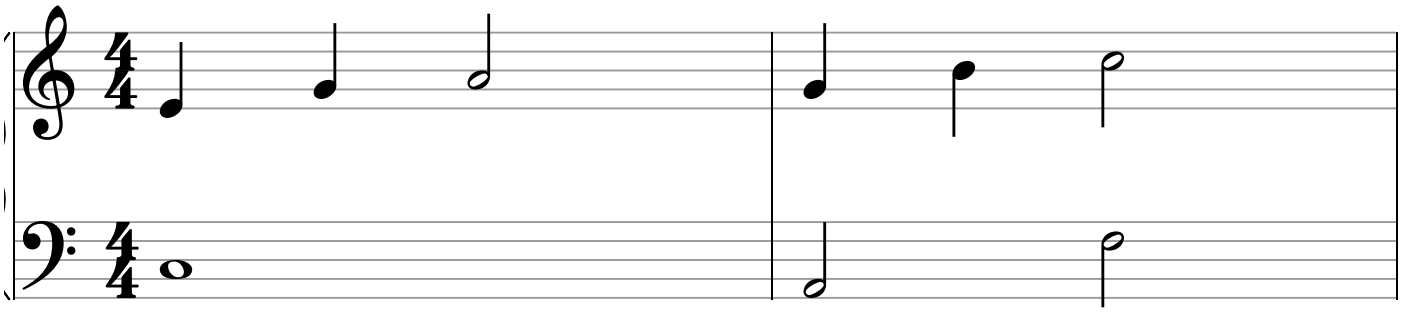
Connect local gestures to one larger destination.

Shape a long musical sentence

Mark the phrase beginning, high point and arrival. A short crescendo may belong inside a longer diminuendo; avoid treating every bar as a separate swell. Sing the line and notice where it needs a breath. Keep accompaniment intensity tied to the melodic destination instead of its finger difficulty.

Practise · One destination in four bars

Build gently toward D5 in bar 3, then settle into the ending.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · An answering phrase

Make this answer sound related to the first sentence.

Practise independently

Play both phrases without a demonstration. Mark one principal destination for each and explain how the ending sounds different from the middle.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

3. Pedal for clarity and colour

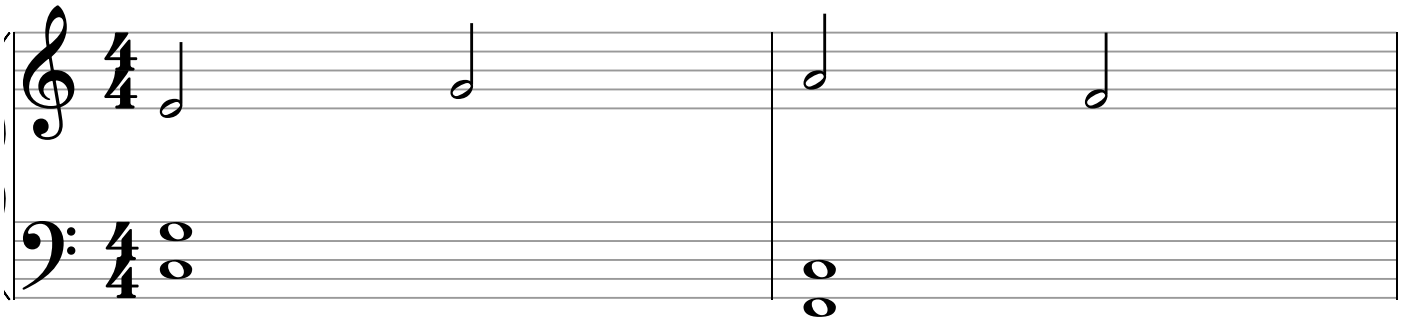
Listen to the instrument instead of relying on a fixed foot pattern.

Pedal for clarity and colour

Learn the notes without pedal. For a clean legato change, play the new harmony, lift the pedal enough to clear the old sound, then depress it again. The timing and depth depend on the piano and room. If your digital pedal supports only on/off, use short clear changes; half-pedal requires compatible continuous hardware. More pedal is not a substitute for connected fingering.

Practise · Change with the harmony

First play dry. Offline, add a pedal change after each new left-hand harmony.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Listen to moving bass notes

Keep this dry at first; avoid carrying all four bass notes into one blur.

Practise independently

Compare no pedal, frequent changes and longer pedal offline. Choose the clearest version that still supports the phrase. The app does not verify pedal position or acoustic clarity.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

4. Choose articulation that fits the hymn
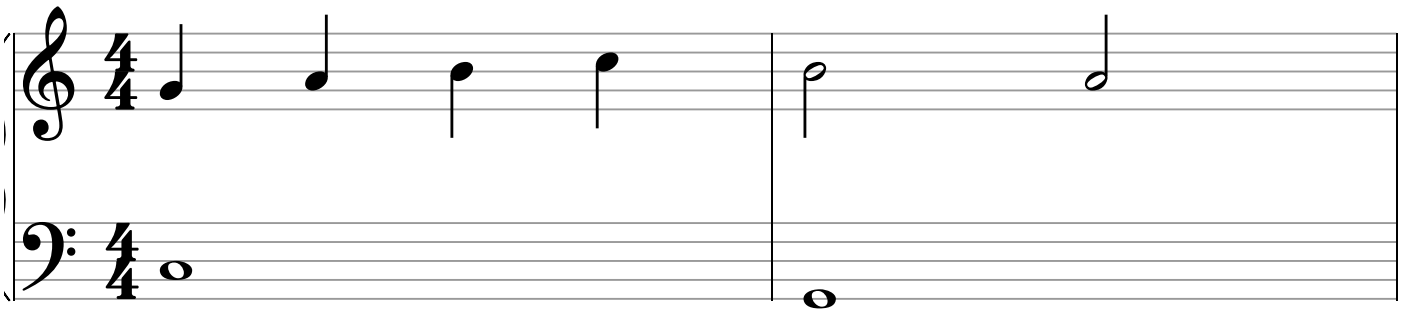
Separate a breath from an accidental break in the line.

Choose articulation that fits the hymn

A solemn chorale, a lilting hymn and a solo prelude need different touches. Choose where notes connect, where consonant-like releases clarify the rhythm, and where a phrase breath belongs. Practise the same line legato and gently detached offline. The written reference gives the pitches and rhythm; your release and tone choices supply the character.

Practise · Connected reference

Join the melody with the fingers before adding pedal.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Space for a breath

Keep the rests audible and arrive together after them.

Practise independently

Perform one phrase in two distinct characters and describe the releases you changed. Keep the same basic pulse so the contrast comes from articulation, not accidental rushing.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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5. Use a recording as a teacher
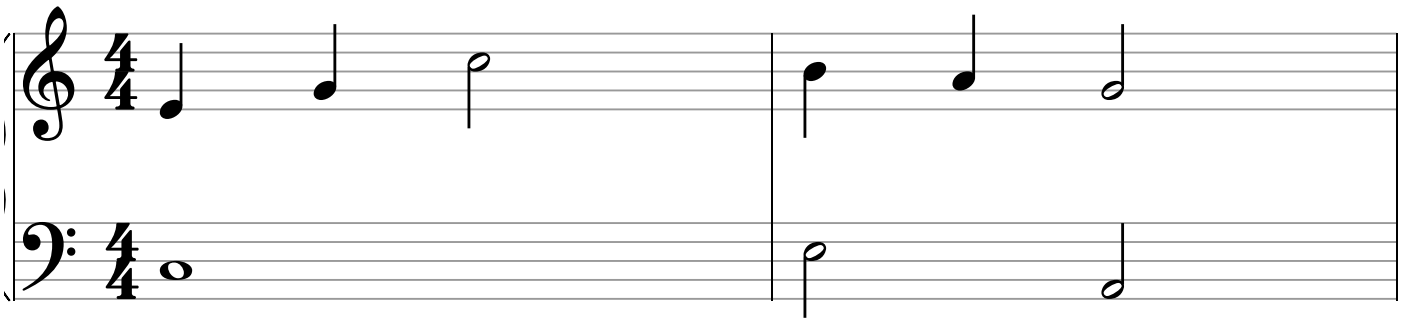
Compare an intended musical result with what is actually audible.

Use a recording as a teacher

Before recording, name one listening question: Is the tune clear? Are the pedal changes clean? Does the final cadence sound prepared? Make one uninterrupted take without correcting during playback. Listen once for the whole phrase and once for your question. Choose a single repair; do not turn the recording into a list of every imperfect note.

Practise · A short recorded take

If you have a recorder, capture this once. Keep going after a small slip.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A second take with one change

Try a quieter accompaniment, keeping the melodic pulse unchanged.

Practise independently

Keep a brief practice note: intended change, audible result, next step. A completed pitch check cannot answer your tone question; listening can.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

---

6. Abide with Me: a long musical sentence

Sing the phrase before playing. Choose one destination, lighten supporting tones and let the cadence settle without losing the line.

Prepare the score

Sing the phrase before playing. Choose one destination, lighten supporting tones and let the cadence settle without losing the line.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Sing the phrase before playing. Choose one destination, lighten supporting tones and let the cadence settle without losing the line.

Practise · Abide with Me: a long musical sentence

Sing the phrase before playing. Choose one destination, lighten supporting tones and let the cadence settle without losing the line.

Make your own musical decision

Record a dry version and a pedalled version. Keep the one in which the phrase is connected and the harmony remains clear.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

---

7. Just As I Am: listening through pedal changes

Learn this 6/4 setting without pedal. Add changes after new harmonies sound, listening for a clean bass and an unbroken tune.

Prepare the score
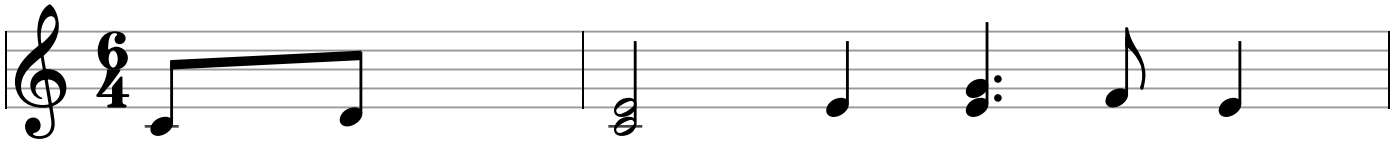
Learn this 6/4 setting without pedal. Add changes after new harmonies sound, listening for a clean bass and an unbroken tune.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 6/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Learn this 6/4 setting without pedal. Add changes after new harmonies sound, listening for a clean bass and an unbroken tune.

Practise · Just As I Am: listening through pedal changes

Learn this 6/4 setting without pedal. Add changes after new harmonies sound, listening for a clean bass and an unbroken tune.

Make your own musical decision

If your pedal supports continuous depth, compare shallow and deeper use offline. With an on/off pedal, prefer shorter clean changes.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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8. It Is Well with My Soul: lyrical piano

Sustain a clear melodic sentence, balance the paired right-hand notes and clear the pedal as the harmony changes. Let the ending sound prepared.

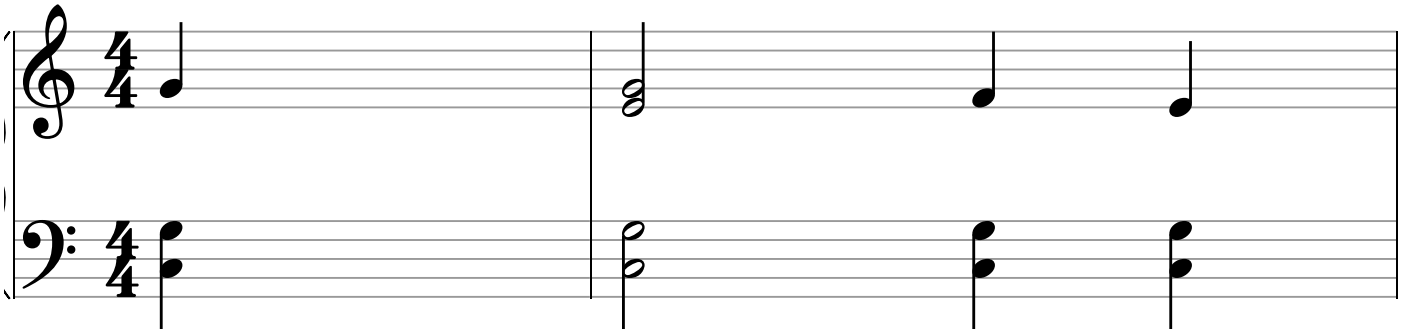
Prepare a complete performance

Sustain a clear melodic sentence, balance the paired right-hand notes and clear the pedal as the harmony changes. Let the ending sound prepared.

Choose a tempo at which you can finish comfortably. Mark three restart points, rehearse the opening and ending, then play without stopping. Afterwards assess pulse, clarity, phrasing, balance and recovery. Completion records a reference play-through, not a graded qualification or approval of an improvised arrangement.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: It Is Well with My Soul

Sustain a clear melodic sentence, balance the paired right-hand notes and clear the pedal as the harmony changes. Let the ending sound prepared.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Sustain a clear melodic sentence, balance the paired right-hand notes and clear the pedal as the harmony changes. Let the ending sound prepared.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Give the upper voice direction without striking it harshly.
- ☐ Connect local gestures to one larger destination.
- ☐ Listen to the instrument instead of relying on a fixed foot pattern.
- ☐ Separate a breath from an accidental break in the line.
- ☐ Compare an intended musical result with what is actually audible.
- ☐ Sustain a clear melodic sentence, balance the paired right-hand notes and clear the pedal as the harmony changes. Let the ending sound prepared.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Independent Hymn Musicianship

Realize chord symbols, transpose, introduce hymns and accompany singers.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Read a lead sheet as a musical plan
2. Transpose by scale degree and function
3. Give a singer a reliable introduction
4. Learn a short phrase by ear
5. Accompany a person, not only a score
6. Holy, Holy, Holy in F: choose the key
7. Come Thou Fount in F: a service-ready texture
8. Come Thou Fount: accompany with confidence

1. Read a lead sheet as a musical plan

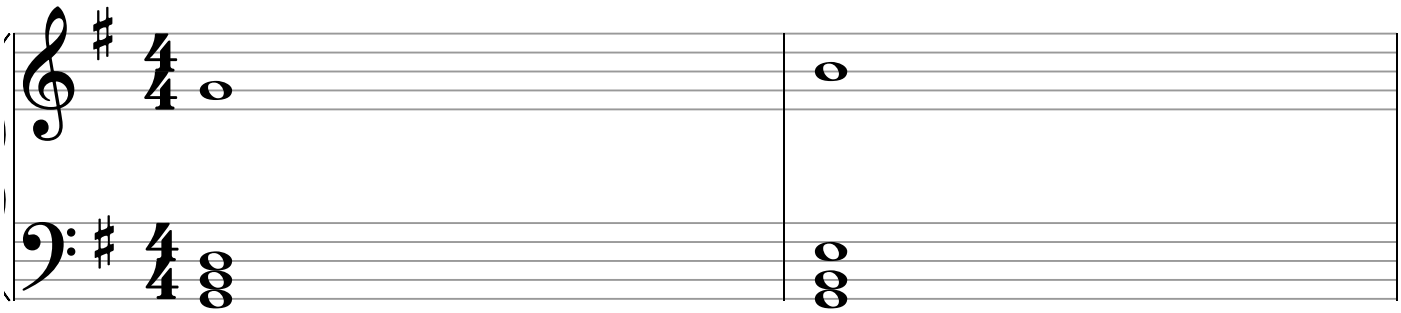
Turn chord symbols into a clear, playable accompaniment.

Read a lead sheet as a musical plan

A chord symbol names a harmony, not an exact register or pattern. In G major, use G-Em-Am-D7-G as a short model. Place the melody where it sings, choose nearby chord inversions and avoid crowding the register directly under the singer. Learn a plain bass-and-chord version before adding flowing notes. The app checks the written realization; alternative voicings belong in your independent practice.

Practise · G–Em–Am–D7–G

Name each chord and hear its function while playing the compact voicing.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Read the bass route

Play this simpler support before choosing a pattern.

Practise independently

Write the five chord symbols without notes and realize them in two textures offline. Keep the melody and chord-change locations the same.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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2. Transpose by scale degree and function
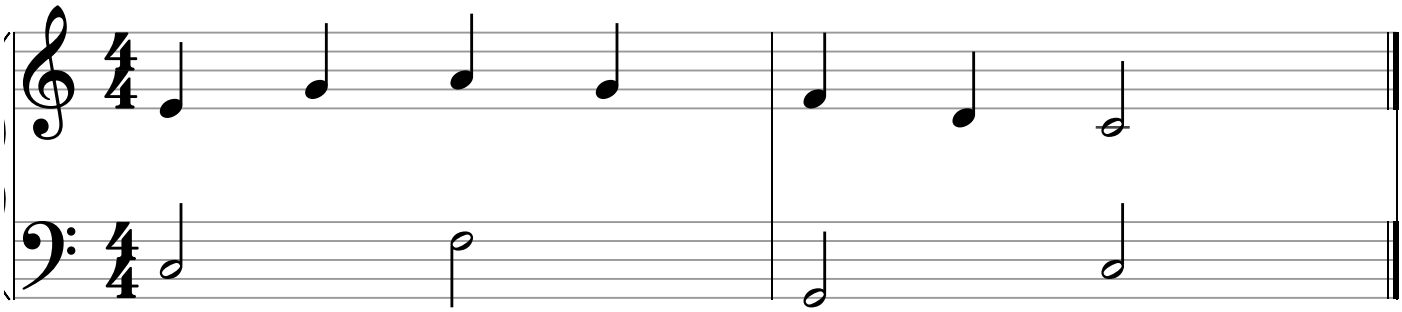
Move a phrase to a singer’s key without counting every semitone.

Transpose by scale degree and function

Label the melody with scale degrees and the chords with functions. In C, E-G-A-G is 3-5-6-5; in D it becomes F-sharp-A-B-A. I-IV-V-I becomes D-G-A-D. Check the new starting pitch and range before playing. Practise one phrase first, then the bass, then both hands. Choose a key for the singer rather than for the pianist’s favourite hand shape.

Practise · The phrase in C

Say 3-5-6-5, 4-2-1 as you play.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · The same functions in D

Prepare F-sharp and C-sharp. Keep the interval pattern.

Practise independently

Transpose the phrase into F offline, then try one hymn phrase in a second key. Name the highest and lowest melody notes before deciding the key is suitable.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

3. Give a singer a reliable introduction

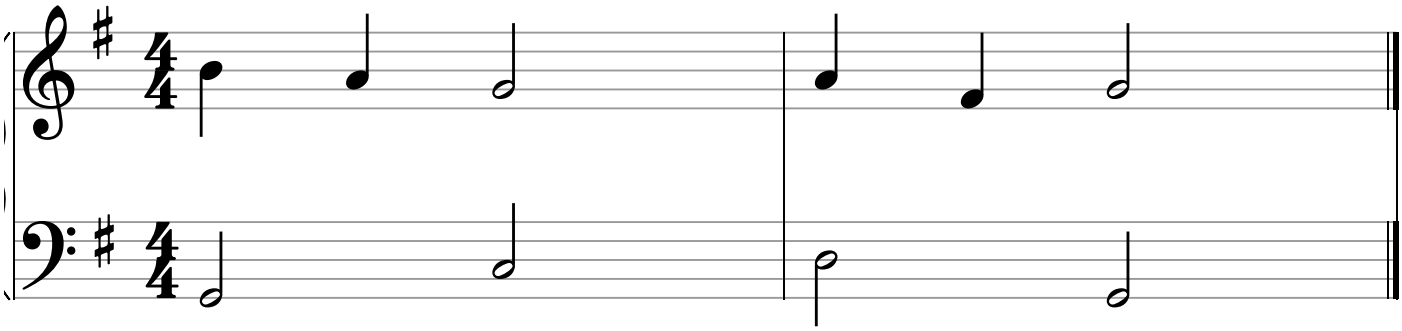
Establish key, meter, tempo and a clear entry.

Give a singer a reliable introduction

A useful introduction tells the singer when and where to enter. Use a recognizable closing phrase or a short tonic-dominant pattern, keep the intended tempo and leave room for a breath. Rehearse the pickup count explicitly. Avoid a decorative flourish that leaves the starting beat unclear. Agree on the introduction before accompanying someone.

Practise · A short introduction in G

Set the pulse, cadence on G and imagine a clear entry on the next beat.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Prepare a pickup

Count the rest, then treat D as a light pickup leading into G.

Practise independently

Choose the last two or four bars of a hymn as an introduction offline. Count an imaginary singer in, then ask a real singer whether the entry felt clear.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

4. Learn a short phrase by ear

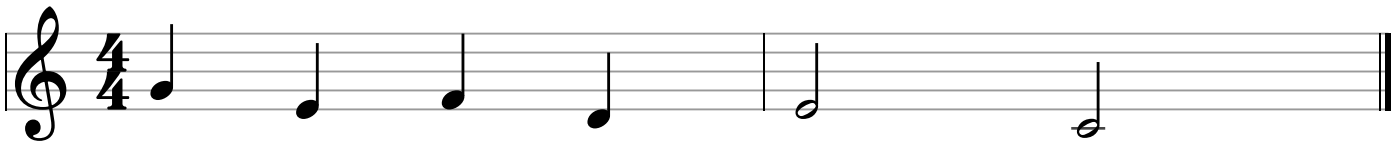
Use singing, tonal landmarks and comparison before notation.

Learn a short phrase by ear

Choose a phrase short enough to sing accurately. Find its home note and first pitch, then hear steps, repeated notes and skips. Sing before trying keys, and check only a few notes at a time. In the first exercise, use Listen, turn away from the score and sing back before playing. The app provides a reference, not an automatic assessment of a new melody you invent.

Practise · Listen, sing, then find

Listen once, look away, sing the phrase and find it at the piano. Then compare with the score.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Hear the bass function

Listen for home, away, dominant and home; name the roots before looking.

Practise independently

Choose a different familiar hymn phrase and learn it away from the screen. Write or play it from memory, then compare with a verified score to catch guessed intervals.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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5. Accompany a person, not only a score

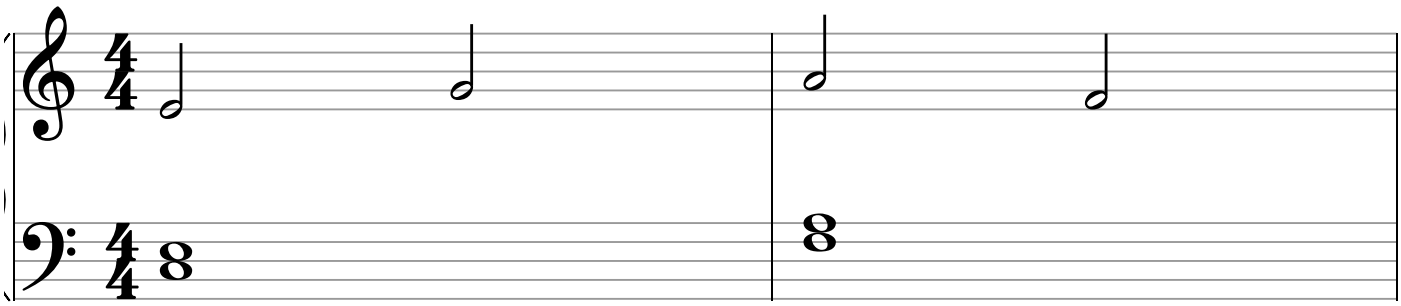
Support breaths, entries, balance and recovery.

Accompany a person, not only a score

Agree on key, tempo, introduction, verse count and ending before playing. Listen to the singer’s consonants and breaths. Keep the tune audible enough to guide an entry without overpowering the voice. If the singer skips ahead, simplify to bass and essential harmony and join at the next shared landmark. Practise with another person when possible; solo app playback cannot simulate all their timing choices.

Practise · A plain support model

Imagine singing above these quiet harmonies. Keep the pulse easy to predict.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A secure re-entry

Start here as if joining a singer at the final phrase.

Practise independently

Rehearse with a singer or sing while playing. Agree on one held ending, one breath and one restart point. Practise a simplified recovery offline, then return to the written model for the app check.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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6. Holy, Holy, Holy in F: choose the key

Prepare the melody in F and compare its highest and lowest notes with the D-major version. Use scale degrees and functions to understand the move.

Prepare the score
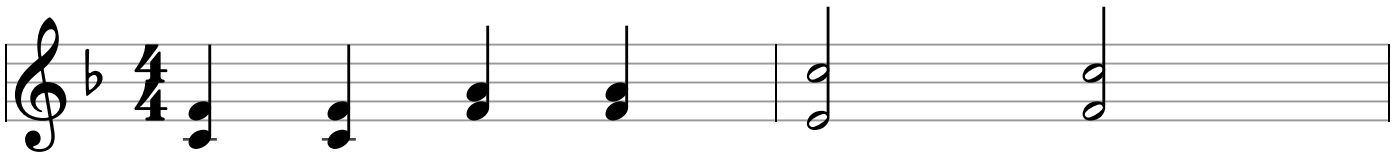
Prepare the melody in F and compare its highest and lowest notes with the D-major version. Use scale degrees and functions to understand the move.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 4/4 · F · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Prepare the melody in F and compare its highest and lowest notes with the D-major version. Use scale degrees and functions to understand the move.

Practise · Holy, Holy, Holy in F: choose the key

Prepare the melody in F and compare its highest and lowest notes with the D-major version. Use scale degrees and functions to understand the move.

Make your own musical decision

Sing the opening in both keys. Decide which is more comfortable for your intended singer, without assuming the higher key is better.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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7. Come Thou Fount in F: a service-ready texture

Prepare the F-major accompaniment, agree on a tempo and imagine a singer entering after a short recognizable introduction.

Prepare the score
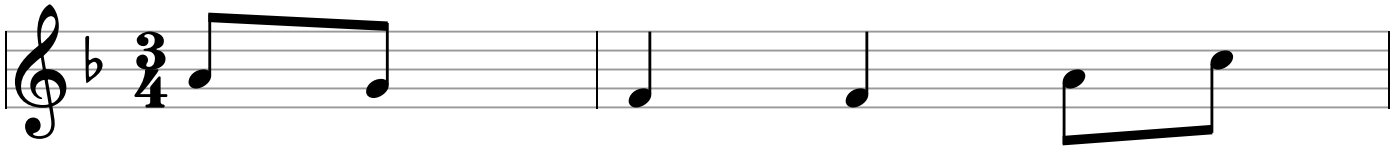
Prepare the F-major accompaniment, agree on a tempo and imagine a singer entering after a short recognizable introduction.

The left-hand pattern samples the retained source harmonies at each eighth note. It is an original piano accompaniment.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 3/4 · F · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Prepare the F-major accompaniment, agree on a tempo and imagine a singer entering after a short recognizable introduction.

Practise · Come Thou Fount in F: a service-ready texture

Prepare the F-major accompaniment, agree on a tempo and imagine a singer entering after a short recognizable introduction.

Make your own musical decision

Create a two- or four-bar introduction from the ending offline. Rehearse the pickup, one breath and a shared final release with a singer if possible.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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8. Come Thou Fount: accompany with confidence

Before the written reference run, play your own introduction offline and sing one phrase while accompanying. In the app, keep the printed D-major model clear, steady and supportive.

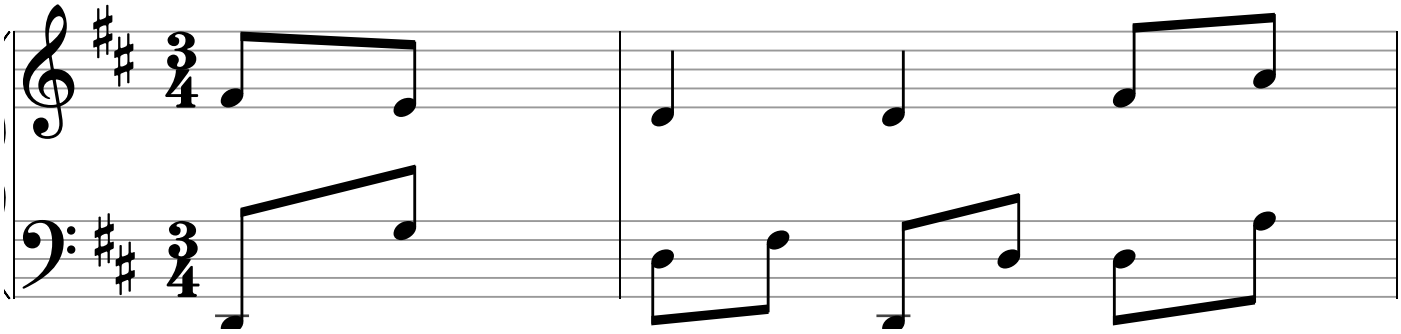
Prepare a complete performance

Before the written reference run, play your own introduction offline and sing one phrase while accompanying. In the app, keep the printed D-major model clear, steady and supportive.

Choose a tempo at which you can finish comfortably. Mark three restart points, rehearse the opening and ending, then play without stopping. Afterwards assess pulse, clarity, phrasing, balance and recovery. Completion records a reference play-through, not a graded qualification or approval of an improvised arrangement.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Come Thou Fount

Before the written reference run, play your own introduction offline and sing one phrase while accompanying. In the app, keep the printed D-major model clear, steady and supportive.



Opening example · 3/4 · D · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Your recital

Before the written reference run, play your own introduction offline and sing one phrase while accompanying. In the app, keep the printed D-major model clear, steady and supportive.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- ☐ Turn chord symbols into a clear, playable accompaniment.
- ☐ Move a phrase to a singer’s key without counting every semitone.
- ☐ Establish key, meter, tempo and a clear entry.
- ☐ Use singing, tonal landmarks and comparison before notation.
- ☐ Support breaths, entries, balance and recovery.
- ☐ Before the written reference run, play your own introduction offline and sing one phrase while accompanying. In the app, keep the printed D-major model clear, steady and supportive.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?

Building a Recital Programme

Contrasting repertoire, multiple entry points, recovery and an independent next plan.

How to use these notes

Read alongside the lessons or keep beside your piano. Review the explanations, try the practice tasks, then use the checklist without on-screen hints. Listening and demonstrations are available in the app. Notation examples show the opening two bars; full songs are in the Songbook.

In this chapter

1. Build a programme with contrast
2. Build several paths into a piece
3. Rehearse recovery before performance
4. Make a realistic dress rehearsal
5. Continue as an independent pianist
6. Dress rehearsal: a broad chorale
7. Dress rehearsal: flowing movement in F
8. Final programme: chorale, lyrical hymn and flowing hymn

1. Build a programme with contrast

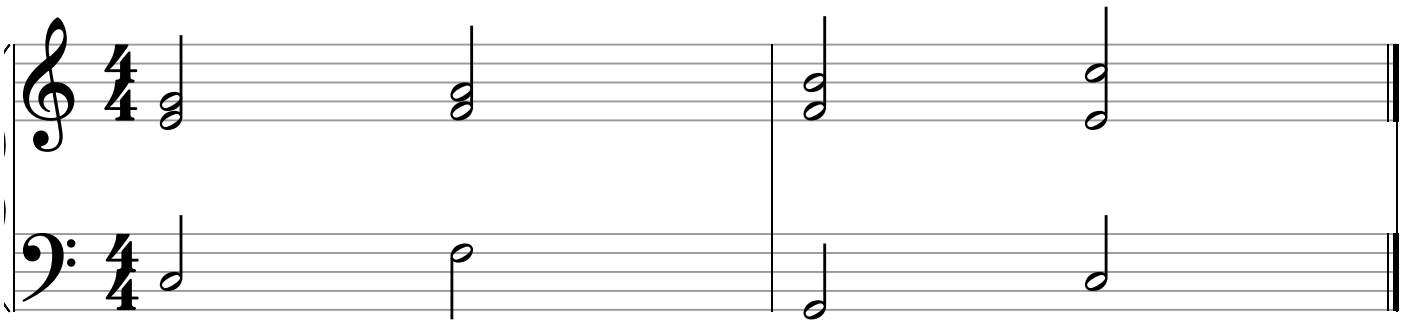
Choose pieces that show different musical strengths.

Build a programme with contrast

A programme should offer contrast without exceeding reliable technique. Combine a clear chorale, a flowing hymn and a lyrical performance. Check the keys, registers, character and duration, and decide where a short silence belongs. Start with something secure. A harder piece is not a better opening if its first movement feels unpredictable.

Practise · A chorale character

Use a broad, clear pulse and a singing upper voice.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A flowing character

Keep the same clear melody above an even, lighter accompaniment.

Practise independently

Write a short programme note for each final hymn: its character, principal technical demand and one intended musical effect. Keep the programme within what you can finish comfortably.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

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2. Build several paths into a piece
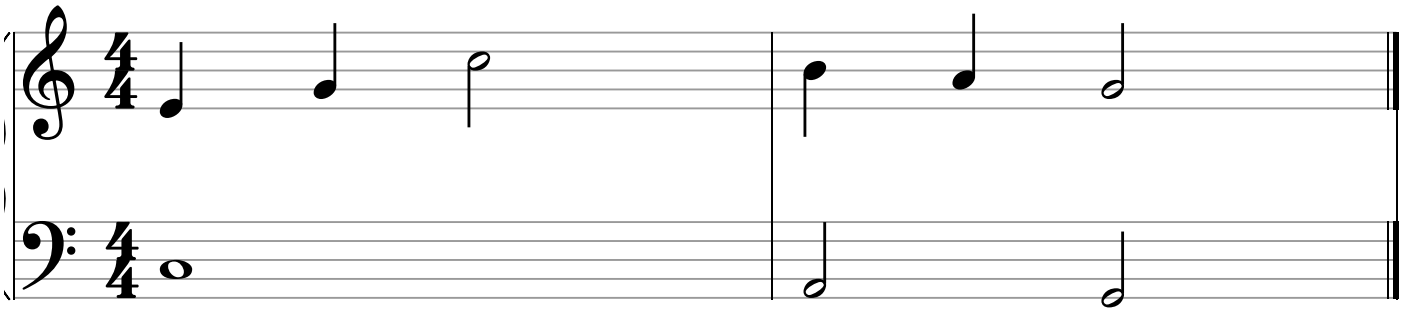
Use harmony, melody and movement instead of one memorized chain.

Build several paths into a piece

Choose phrase beginnings as landmarks and name their bass, melody and harmony. Start from each one without running in from the beginning. Sing the next phrase before playing. Memory becomes more reliable when you can describe the music as well as repeat its movements. Performing with a score remains a valid choice; the goal is secure navigation.

Practise · Landmark one: tonic

Name the first melody note and bass before entering.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Landmark two: dominant

Begin directly on the dominant and hear its arrival at home.

Practise independently

Choose three landmarks in every recital piece. Begin from them in a different order offline and describe the harmony before each entry.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

3. Rehearse recovery before performance

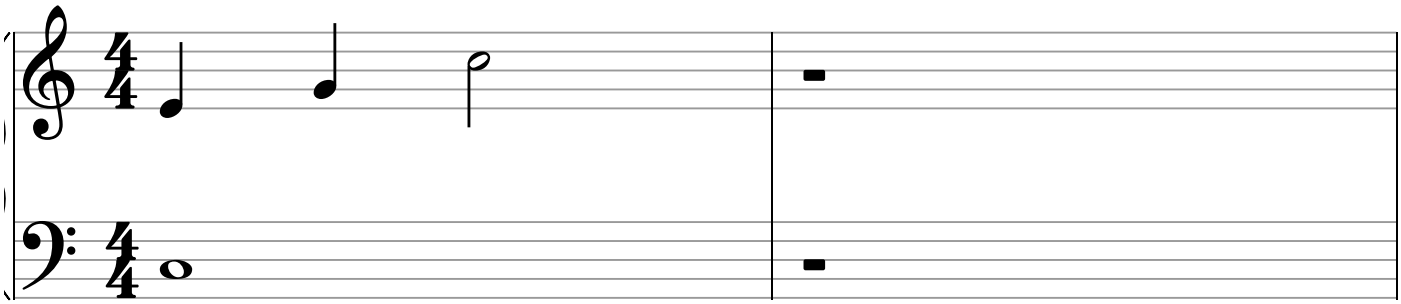
Keep the musical sentence moving after a small error.

Rehearse recovery before performance

A performance is not repair practice. Choose a safe next beat or phrase and continue after a missed note. Practise counting a planned silent bar, then re-entering accurately. Do this away from an ordinary pitch-by-pitch check, which waits for the written notes. Use Flow for a timed reference run and independent practice for deliberate omissions.

Practise · Count through an empty bar

Keep counting during the written silence and re-enter on the next downbeat.



Opening example · 4/4 · C · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A dependable ending

Practise the final cadence as its own starting point.

Practise independently

Offline, deliberately omit one accompaniment chord while keeping the beat, then continue at a landmark. Restore the full score on the next run. The aim is a calm recovery, not rehearsing wrong notes.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

4. Make a realistic dress rehearsal

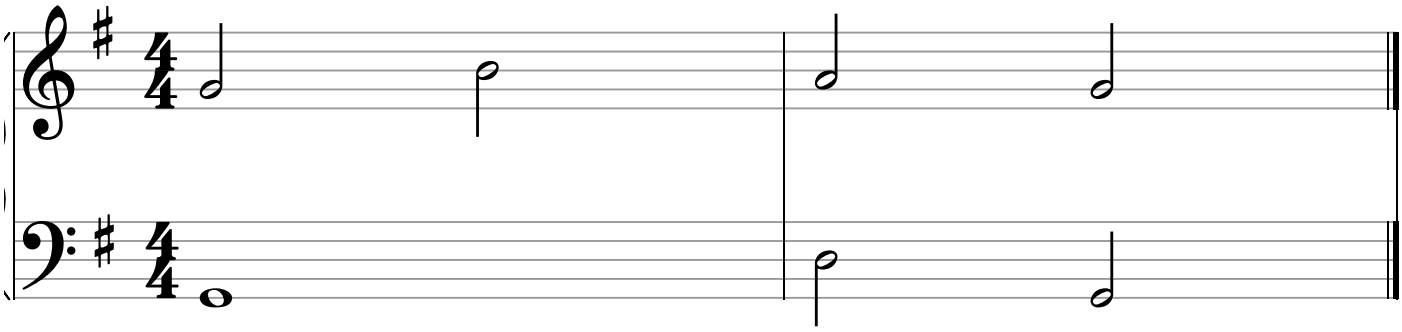
Test the whole routine, including starts, pauses and endings.

Make a realistic dress rehearsal

Set the bench, choose the score display and prepare the pedal before beginning. Announce the first piece if useful, take a quiet breath and start from silence. Play the complete programme without adjustments between phrases. Leave a short pause between pieces. Afterwards review the musical result, not only the number of missed notes. Test the same instrument and room when possible.

Practise · A prepared start

Count a silent bar before your first attack. Let both hands begin deliberately.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · A deliberate ending

Keep the final chord sounding, then release hands and pedal together offline.

Practise independently

Run all final pieces, including the spaces between them, at your piano. Record the programme if possible. Choose at most two repair passages before the next full run.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

5. Continue as an independent pianist

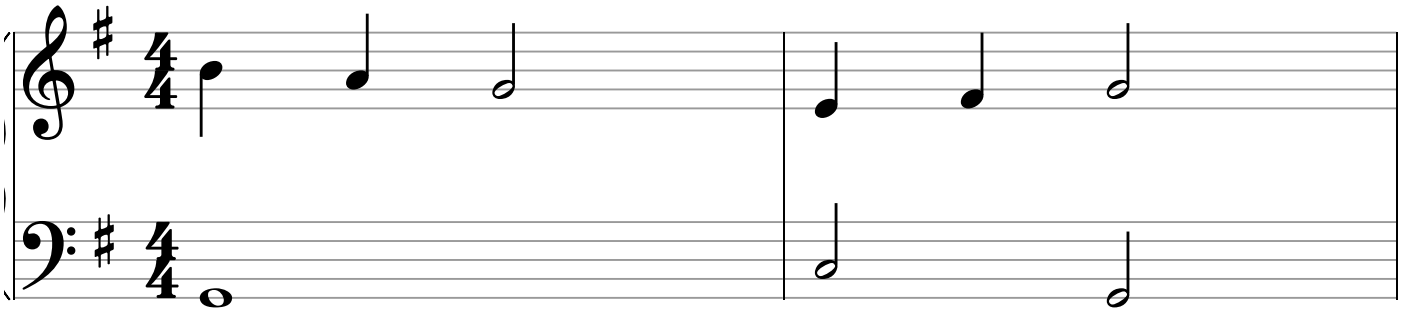
Choose new repertoire and a sustainable next study plan.

Continue as an independent pianist

After this course, choose music by reading a sample, listening to its demands and identifying one manageable stretch beyond your current skill. Keep technique, sight-reading, ear work and repertoire in the weekly routine. A teacher or experienced musician can hear voicing, tension and ensemble issues that a note checker cannot judge. Use feedback to choose your next goal rather than simply seeking harder notes.

Practise · Read, analyse, then play

Name the key, bass route and phrase ending before beginning.



Opening example · 4/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · One final musical sentence

Choose a destination and make the accompaniment serve it.

Practise independently

Choose one new public-domain hymn, make a source note, preview its demands and plan a week of study. Include one listening goal, one technical repair, one ear task and one complete performance.

Use a short bar loop to repair a passage, then reconnect it to the phrase. The app checks the written pitches; Flow checks note-start timing. Listen for duration, tone, balance and pedal, and check physical ease yourself. Creative alternatives are practised away from the reference-score check.

6. Dress rehearsal: a broad chorale

Play the entire hymn without stopping. Make the top line sing and keep the inner support light.

Prepare the score

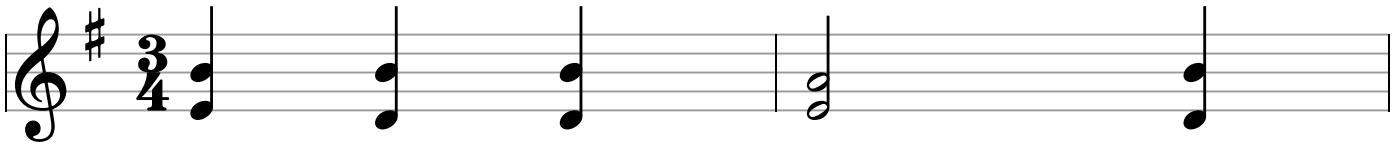
Play the entire hymn without stopping. Make the top line sing and keep the inner support light.

This is a melody-led piano reduction: supporting tones change with the melody. Source inner voices may be moved by octaves or rearticulated; study their original rhythms using the source score.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 3/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Play the entire hymn without stopping. Make the top line sing and keep the inner support light.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: a broad chorale

Play the entire hymn without stopping. Make the top line sing and keep the inner support light.

Make your own musical decision

Name the start, middle and final-cadence landmarks. Begin from each in a different order, then make one complete run.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

7. Dress rehearsal: flowing movement in F

Keep the eighth-note accompaniment even beneath a clear chromatic tune. Prepare the new key

before the first note.

Prepare the score
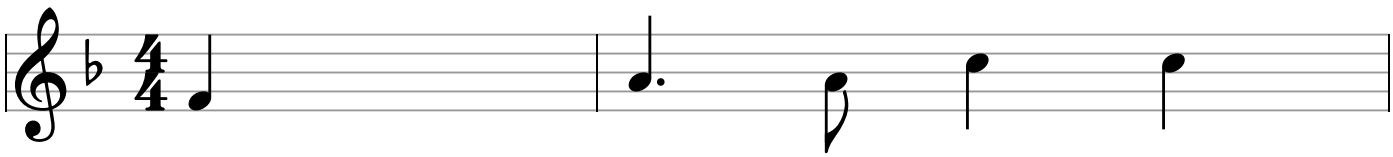
Keep the eighth-note accompaniment even beneath a clear chromatic tune. Prepare the new key before the first note.

The left-hand pattern samples the retained source harmonies at each eighth note. It is an original piano accompaniment.

Preview the key, meter, pickup and ending. Prepare a stable fingering before adding speed.

Practise · Right hand: voice the melody

Read the upper line first. Where there are two notes, keep the top voice clearer. Release unnecessary pressure.



Opening example · 4/4 · F · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Left hand: shape the support

Count aloud and play softly. Move the arm between positions; do not hold a wide stretch.

Practise · Join the opening

Keep the eighth-note accompaniment even beneath a clear chromatic tune. Prepare the new key before the first note.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: flowing movement in F

Keep the eighth-note accompaniment even beneath a clear chromatic tune. Prepare the new key before the first note.

Make your own musical decision

Record the whole performance. Choose one movement repair and one musical change, then test both in the complete phrase.

Practise the alternative at your piano, then return to the written reference if using the app’s pitch check. Record yourself if possible and describe one audible improvement.

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8. Final programme: chorale, lyrical hymn and flowing hymn

Perform three complete contrasting hymns with a short silence between them. Show a clear melody, reliable pulse, comfortable movement, clean pedal, planned interpretation and calm recovery. Practise a personal interpretation offline before playing these written reference

arrangements.

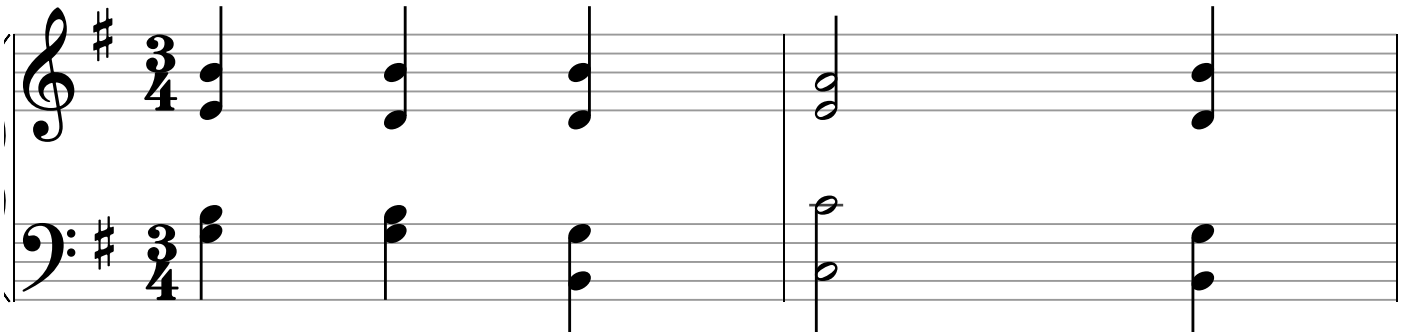
Prepare a complete performance

Perform three complete contrasting hymns with a short silence between them. Show a clear melody, reliable pulse, comfortable movement, clean pedal, planned interpretation and calm recovery. Practise a personal interpretation offline before playing these written reference arrangements.

Choose a tempo at which you can finish comfortably. Mark three restart points, rehearse the opening and ending, then play without stopping. Afterwards assess pulse, clarity, phrasing, balance and recovery. Completion records a reference play-through, not a graded qualification or approval of an improvised arrangement.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee

Perform three complete contrasting hymns with a short silence between them. Show a clear melody, reliable pulse, comfortable movement, clean pedal, planned interpretation and calm recovery. Practise a personal interpretation offline before playing these written reference arrangements.



Opening example · 3/4 · G · finger 1 = thumb

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Abide with Me

Perform three complete contrasting hymns with a short silence between them. Show a clear melody, reliable pulse, comfortable movement, clean pedal, planned interpretation and calm recovery. Practise a personal interpretation offline before playing these written reference arrangements.

Practise · Dress rehearsal: Eternal Father, Strong to Save

Perform three complete contrasting hymns with a short silence between them. Show a clear melody, reliable pulse, comfortable movement, clean pedal, planned interpretation and calm recovery. Practise a personal interpretation offline before playing these written reference arrangements.

Practise · Performance 1: Jesus, the Very Thought of Thee

Perform three complete contrasting hymns with a short silence between them. Show a clear melody, reliable pulse, comfortable movement, clean pedal, planned interpretation and calm recovery. Practise a personal interpretation offline before playing these written reference arrangements.

Practise · Performance 2: Abide with Me

Perform three complete contrasting hymns with a short silence between them. Show a clear melody, reliable pulse, comfortable movement, clean pedal, planned interpretation and calm recovery. Practise a personal interpretation offline before playing these written reference arrangements.

Practise · Performance 3: Eternal Father, Strong to Save

Perform three complete contrasting hymns with a short silence between them. Show a clear melody, reliable pulse, comfortable movement, clean pedal, planned interpretation and calm recovery. Practise a personal interpretation offline before playing these written reference arrangements.

Can I do this independently?

Try these at your piano with hints and note labels turned off. Tick a box when you can do it comfortably; return to the matching lesson when you need a reminder.

- [ ] Choose pieces that show different musical strengths.
- [ ] Use harmony, melody and movement instead of one memorized chain.
- [ ] Keep the musical sentence moving after a small error.
- [ ] Test the whole routine, including starts, pauses and endings.
- [ ] Choose new repertoire and a sustainable next study plan.
- [ ] Perform three complete contrasting hymns with a short silence between them. Show a clear melody, reliable pulse, comfortable movement, clean pedal, planned interpretation and calm recovery. Practise a personal interpretation offline before playing these written reference arrangements.

My next practice goal

What sounded better? What still needs work?
